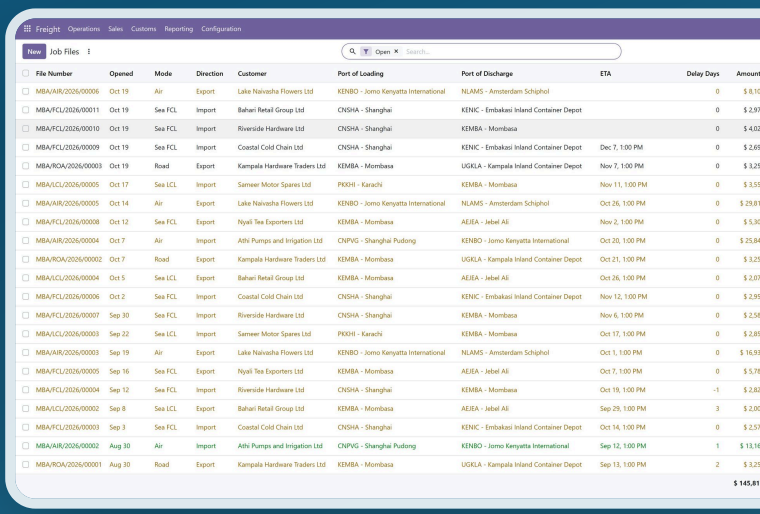
WAY4TECH

Freight Forwarding and Customs Clearance

A step by step guide to running air, sea and road job files, bills of lading, containers, customs entries and the money, on Odoo 20.



Freight Forwarding Management wt_freight_forwarding

For Odoo 20, Community or Enterprise

Edition 1, October 2026

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Read chapters 1 to 3 once, in order, when the system is being set up. After that go straight to the chapter for the job in front of you. Every screen in this guide was taken from a working demonstration database, so you can follow each chapter with the system open beside you.

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Screens were taken in October 2026 from the demonstration database of Meridian Freight Services, a forwarder and licensed customs broker with offices in Mombasa and Nairobi. Your company name, currency, ports and figures will differ. The system runs on Odoo 20 Community or Enterprise and needs the Accounting application for invoicing.

CHAPTER 1

What the system does

One file per shipment, from the rate you quoted to the invoice you raised and the profit you actually made on it. Air, sea full container, sea groupage and road all run through the same file.

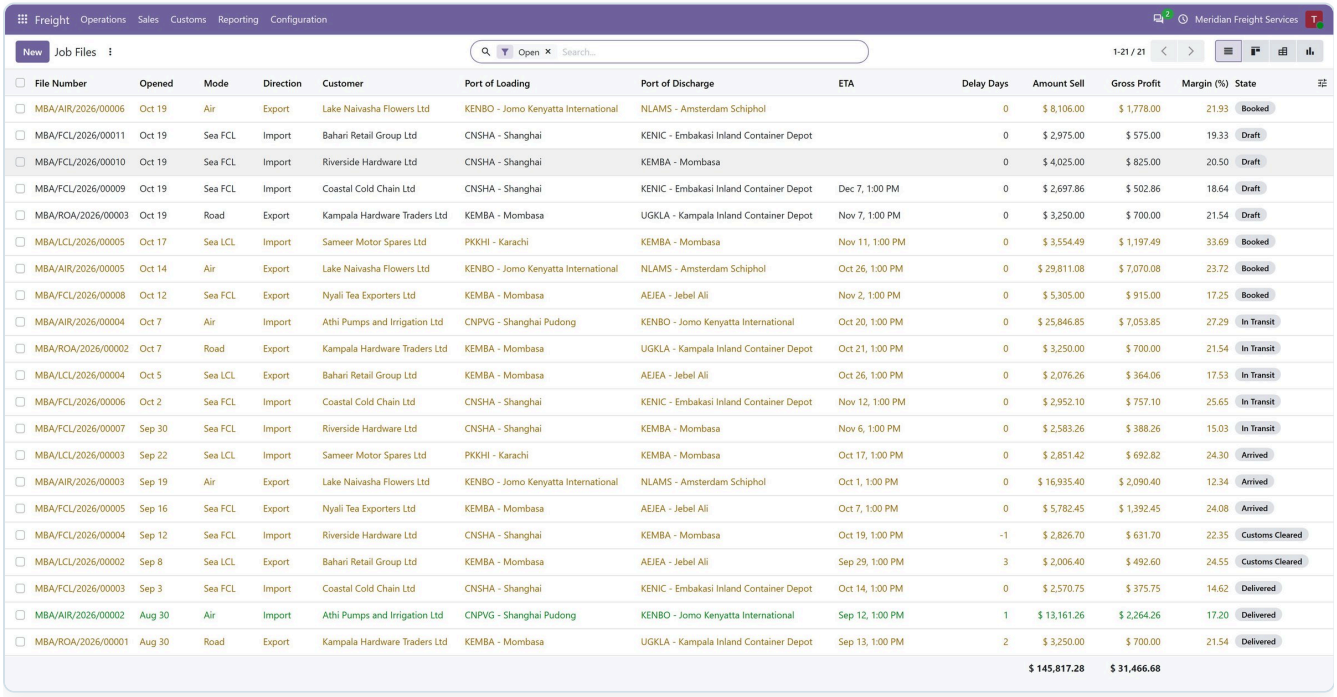
In this chapter

- The job file
- The four modes
- What is in the box
- What it needs from Odoo
- The demonstration company
- How to read this guide

The job file

Everything hangs off one record: the job file. It carries the customer, the shipper, the consignee and the notify party, the incoterm, where the cargo was loaded and where it is discharged, the trade lane it belongs to and the salesperson whose number it lands on.

Onto that file go the cargo, the containers, the routing legs, the bills of lading, the customs entry and every charge. The invoice to the customer and the bill from the shipping line are both raised from those charges, which is why the gross profit on the file is a fact rather than a guess.



File Number	Opened	Mode	Direction	Customer	Port of Loading	Port of Discharge	ETA	Delay Days	Amount Sell	Gross Profit	Margin (%)	State
MBA/AIR/2026/00006	Oct 19	Air	Export	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol		0	$ 8,106.00	$ 1,778.00	21.93	Booked
MBA/FCL/2026/00011	Oct 19	Sea FCL	Import	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot		0	$ 2,975.00	$ 575.00	19.33	Draft
MBA/FCL/2026/00010	Oct 19	Sea FCL	Import	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa		0	$ 4,025.00	$ 825.00	20.50	Draft
MBA/FCL/2026/00009	Oct 19	Sea FCL	Import	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Dec 7, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,697.86	$ 502.86	18.64	Draft
MBA/ROA/2026/00003	Oct 19	Road	Export	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container Depot	Nov 7, 1:00 PM	0	$ 3,250.00	$ 700.00	21.54	Draft
MBA/LCL/2026/00005	Oct 17	Sea LCL	Import	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Nov 11, 1:00 PM	0	$ 3,554.49	$ 1,197.49	33.69	Booked
MBA/AIR/2026/00005	Oct 14	Air	Export	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Oct 26, 1:00 PM	0	$ 29,811.08	$ 7,070.08	23.72	Booked
MBA/FCL/2026/00008	Oct 12	Sea FCL	Export	Nyali Tea Exporters Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Nov 2, 1:00 PM	0	$ 5,305.00	$ 915.00	17.25	Booked
MBA/AIR/2026/00004	Oct 7	Air	Import	Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd	CNPVG - Shanghai Pudong	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	Oct 20, 1:00 PM	0	$ 25,846.85	$ 7,053.85	27.29	In Transit
MBA/ROA/2026/00002	Oct 7	Road	Export	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container Depot	Oct 21, 1:00 PM	0	$ 3,250.00	$ 700.00	21.54	In Transit
MBA/LCL/2026/00004	Oct 5	Sea LCL	Export	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Oct 26, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,076.26	$ 364.06	17.53	In Transit
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MBA/FCL/2026/00007	Sep 30	Sea FCL	Import	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Nov 6, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,583.26	$ 388.26	15.03	In Transit
MBA/LCL/2026/00003	Sep 22	Sea LCL	Import	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 17, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,851.42	$ 692.82	24.30	Arrived
MBA/AIR/2026/00003	Sep 19	Air	Export	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Oct 1, 1:00 PM	0	$ 16,935.40	$ 2,090.40	12.34	Arrived
MBA/FCL/2026/00005	Sep 16	Sea FCL	Export	Nyali Tea Exporters Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Oct 7, 1:00 PM	0	$ 5,782.45	$ 1,392.45	24.08	Arrived
MBA/FCL/2026/00004	Sep 12	Sea FCL	Import	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 19, 1:00 PM	-1	$ 2,826.70	$ 631.70	22.35	Customs Cleared
MBA/LCL/2026/00002	Sep 8	Sea LCL	Export	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Sep 29, 1:00 PM	3	$ 2,006.40	$ 492.60	24.55	Customs Cleared
MBA/FCL/2026/00003	Sep 3	Sea FCL	Import	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Oct 14, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,570.75	$ 375.75	14.62	Delivered
MBA/AIR/2026/00002	Aug 30	Air	Import	Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd	CNPVG - Shanghai Pudong	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	Sep 12, 1:00 PM	1	$ 13,161.26	$ 2,264.26	17.20	Delivered
MBA/ROA/2026/00001	Aug 30	Road	Export	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container Depot	Sep 13, 1:00 PM	2	$ 3,250.00	$ 700.00	21.54	Delivered
									$ 145,817.28	$ 31,466.68		

Figure 1. The file list. One line per shipment, with the ports, the estimated arrival, how many days late it is running, what has been sold on it and what is left after cost.

The four modes

A file is opened in one of four modes, and the mode decides the numbering, the documents the file asks for and how the chargeable weight is worked out.

Mode	Document	Rated on
Air	Air waybill	The greater of the actual weight and the volume at six thousand cubic centimetres to the kilo
Sea FCL	Bill of lading	The container and the TEU. The box is the unit, not the kilo
Sea LCL	Bill of lading	Weight or measure, a tonne to the cubic metre, whichever is greater
Road	CMR consignment note	The truck, or the volume at three thousand cubic centimetres to the kilo

The file number is drawn from a different series for each mode, so anybody reading a reference on a booking knows what they are looking at before they open it. MBA/FCL/2026/00004 is the Mombasa office, a full container, the fourth of the year.

> WHY IT MATTERS
> The mode cannot be changed once the file is booked, because the mode is part of the file number and that number is already on a booking with a carrier. A file opened in the wrong mode is cancelled and opened again, which takes a minute. A file number that means something different from one week to the next costs a great deal more than that.

What is in the box

Area	What you get
Quotations	Rates with a validity date and a transit time, a cost side and a sell side on every line, a printed quotation, and a won quotation that opens the file and carries its rates across.
Job files	Cargo with tariff codes and case dimensions, chargeable weight worked out by mode, a document checklist, and eight states from draft to closed with a check on each one.
Bills	Master and house bills of lading, air waybills and CMR notes. Prepaid or collect, originals or a waybill, telex or express release, and a printed document.
Containers	Number checked against its ISO 6346 check digit, seal, type, tare, cargo weight, verified gross mass and the method it was arrived at, reefer set points, utilisation.
Routing	Pre-carriage, main carriage, transhipment and on-carriage, each with a carrier, a vessel and voyage or a flight number, an estimated and an actual departure and arrival.

Area	What you get
Charges	Cost and sell on one line, each in its own currency, quantities drawn off the file by seven different bases, customer invoices and supplier bills raised straight from them.
Customs	An entry per file with the regime and the office, tariff lines built from the cargo, freight and insurance brought into the value and apportioned, duty, excise and import VAT, and disbursements recharged at cost.
Reporting	Gross profit by file, lane and salesperson, files carrying cost with nothing invoiced, costs with no supplier bill behind them, arrival delays by carrier and lane, and why quotations are lost.

What it needs from Odoo

The system runs on Odoo 20, Community or Enterprise. It uses Odoo's own Accounting application for the invoices and the supplier bills, its contacts for customers, shippers and carriers, and its incoterms. Nothing else is required.

> **TIP**
> Everything in this guide works on Odoo Community. If the business later wants consolidated accounts, a customer portal or the full accounting reports, that is an Odoo Enterprise decision and does not change anything in here.

The demonstration company

Every screen in this guide comes from one demonstration database, so the figures carry across from chapter to chapter and you can follow along.

Company	Meridian Freight Services, a forwarder and a licensed customs broker
Offices	Mombasa, which forwards and clears, and Nairobi, which forwards only
Books kept in	US dollars, with charge lines able to carry their own currency
Lanes	Far East, Middle East, India and South Asia inbound; Europe and the Gulf outbound; and the transit corridor to Uganda
On the system	Twenty five job files across all four modes, fifteen quotations, forty one bills, seven customs entries and about a hundred and fifty charge lines

How to read this guide

Numbered steps are the exact clicks, in order. **Bold blue** is a button or a field as it appears on the screen, and **Operations** > **Job Files** is a menu path: the menu along the top, then the item under it.

Four kinds of note appear in the margin of the text.

TIP

Something that will save you time or trouble.

WHY IT MATTERS

Why the system behaves the way it does. Usually because the alternative costs somebody money.

CAREFUL

Something the system will refuse to do, and what to do instead.

KENYA

Something specific to clearing through KRA and the Mombasa corridor. The system itself is not country specific; the rates and the regimes are yours to set.

CHAPTER 2

Finding your way around

Five menus, four roles. Ten minutes here saves a lot of hunting later, and getting the roles right is what stops a salesperson seeing a file's cost price.

In this chapter

- Logging in
- Opening the app
- The five menus
- The four roles
- Giving somebody a role
- What each role can see

Logging in

1. Open the address you were given in a browser.
2. Type your **Email** and **Password**.
3. Press **Log in**. If you forget the password, **Reset Password** sends you a link, as long as outgoing mail has been set up.

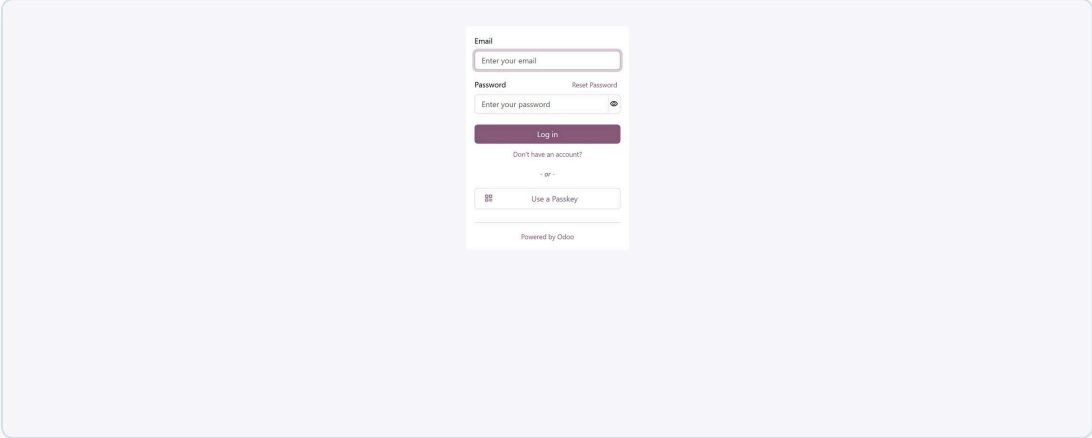
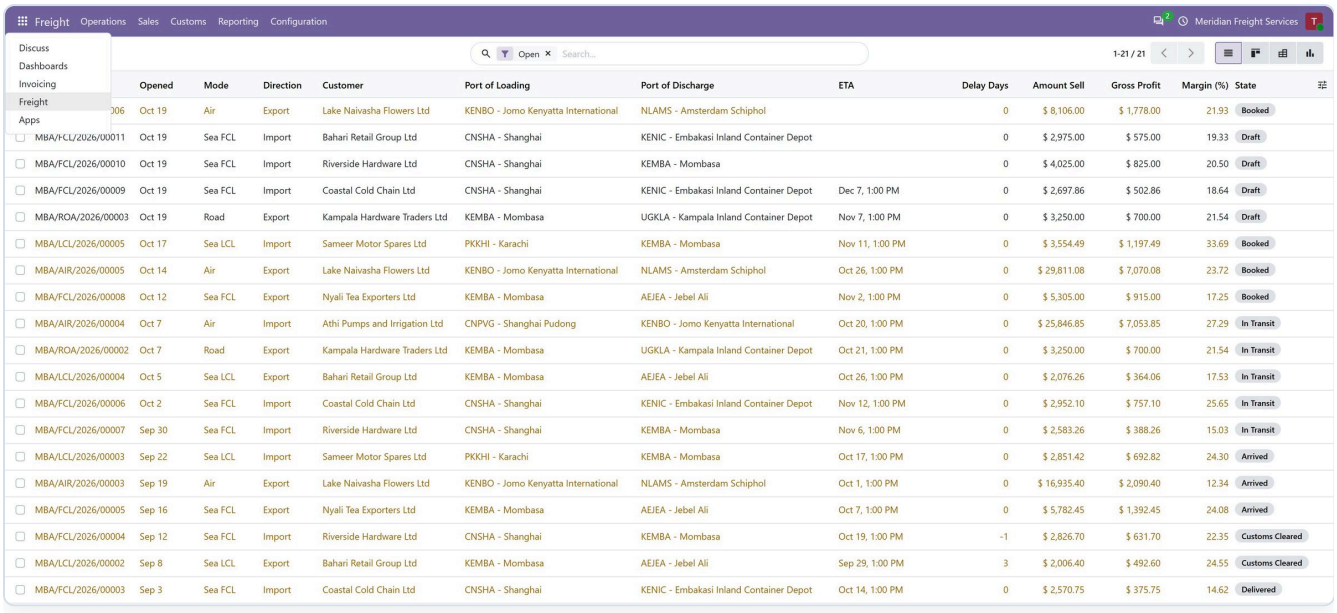


Figure 2. The login screen.

Opening the app

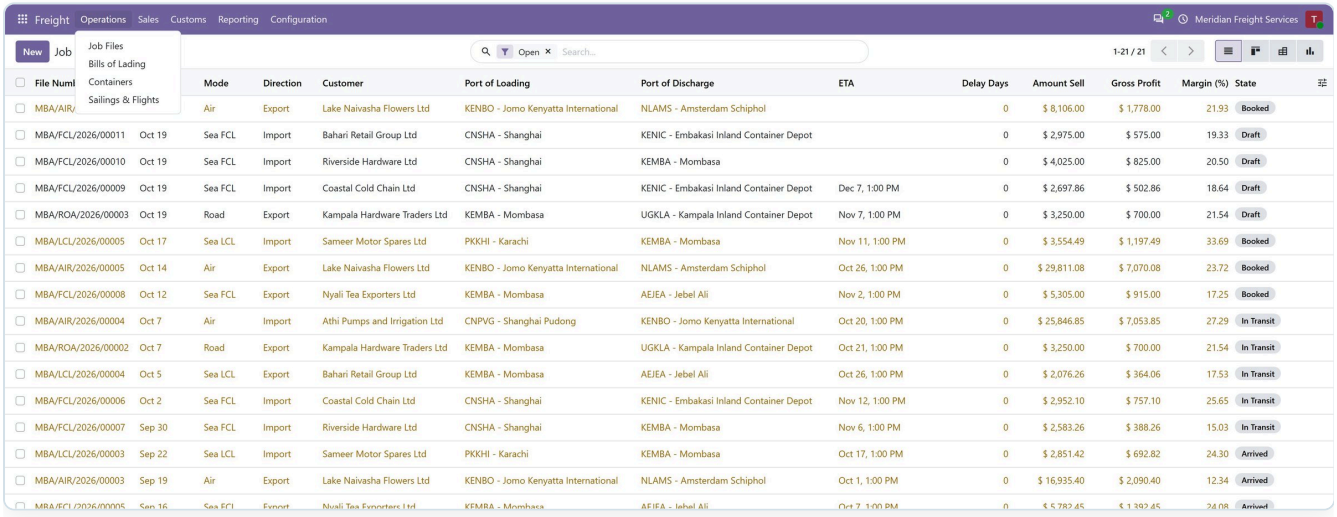
Press the grid of squares at the top left and choose **Freight**. Odoo remembers where you were, so most mornings you will land straight back on the file list.



Opened	Mode	Direction	Customer	Port of Loading	Port of Discharge	ETA	Delay Days	Amount Sell	Gross Profit	Margin (%)	State
Oct 19	Air	Export	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol		0	$ 8,106.00	$ 1,778.00	21.93	Booked
Oct 19	Sea FCL	Import	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot		0	$ 2,975.00	$ 575.00	19.33	Draft
Oct 19	Sea FCL	Import	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa		0	$ 4,025.00	$ 825.00	20.50	Draft
Oct 19	Sea FCL	Import	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Dec 7, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,697.86	$ 502.86	18.64	Draft
Oct 19	Road	Export	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container Depot	Nov 7, 1:00 PM	0	$ 3,250.00	$ 700.00	21.54	Draft
Oct 17	Sea LCL	Import	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Nov 11, 1:00 PM	0	$ 3,554.49	$ 1,197.49	33.69	Booked
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Oct 12	Sea FCL	Export	Nyali Tea Exporters Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Nov 2, 1:00 PM	0	$ 5,305.00	$ 915.00	17.25	Booked
Oct 7	Air	Import	Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd	CNPVG - Shanghai Pudong	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	Oct 20, 1:00 PM	0	$ 25,846.85	$ 7,053.85	27.29	In Transit
Oct 7	Road	Export	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container Depot	Oct 21, 1:00 PM	0	$ 3,250.00	$ 700.00	21.54	In Transit
Oct 5	Sea LCL	Export	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Oct 26, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,076.26	$ 364.06	17.53	In Transit
Oct 2	Sea FCL	Import	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Nov 12, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,952.10	$ 757.10	25.65	In Transit
Sep 30	Sea FCL	Import	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Nov 6, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,583.26	$ 388.26	15.03	In Transit
Sep 22	Sea LCL	Import	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 17, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,851.42	$ 692.82	24.30	Arrived
Sep 19	Air	Export	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Oct 1, 1:00 PM	0	$ 16,935.40	$ 2,090.40	12.34	Arrived
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Sep 8	Sea LCL	Export	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Sep 29, 1:00 PM	3	$ 2,006.40	$ 492.60	24.55	Customs Cleared
Sep 3	Sea FCL	Import	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Oct 14, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,570.75	$ 375.75	14.62	Delivered

Figure 3. The apps menu. Freight sits alongside Invoicing, which is where the invoices raised from a file end up.

The five menus



File Numb	Mode	Direction	Customer	Port of Loading	Port of Discharge	ETA	Delay Days	Amount Sell	Gross Profit	Margin (%)	State
MBA/AIR/	Air	Export	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol		0	$ 8,106.00	$ 1,778.00	21.93	Booked
MBA/FCL/2026/00011	Sea FCL	Import	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot		0	$ 2,975.00	$ 575.00	19.33	Draft
MBA/FCL/2026/00010	Sea FCL	Import	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa		0	$ 4,025.00	$ 825.00	20.50	Draft
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MBA/ROA/2026/00002	Road	Export	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container Depot	Oct 21, 1:00 PM	0	$ 3,250.00	$ 700.00	21.54	In Transit
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MBA/FCL/2026/00006	Sea FCL	Import	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Nov 12, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,952.10	$ 757.10	25.65	In Transit
MBA/FCL/2026/00007	Sea FCL	Import	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Nov 6, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,583.26	$ 388.26	15.03	In Transit
MBA/LCL/2026/00003	Sea LCL	Import	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 17, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,851.42	$ 692.82	24.30	Arrived
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Figure 4. Operations open. Everything that moves cargo is under this one menu.

Menu	What is under it
Operations	**Job Files**, **Bills of Lading**, **Containers**, **Sailings & Flights**. The day to day.
Sales	**Quotations** and **Why We Lose**.
Customs	**Declarations** and **Duty and Tax by Commodity**.
Reporting	**Gross Profit**, **Unbilled Files**, **Costs Without a Bill**, **Arrival Delays**, **All Charges**.
Configuration	**Settings**, **Offices**, **Ports & Airports**, **Trade Lanes**, **Agents**, **Charge Codes**, **Tariff Codes**, **Container Types**, **Document Types**. Set up once, then left alone.

The four roles

Three of the roles sit beside one another rather than on top of one another: a salesperson is not a junior operator, and a customs broker is not a senior one. Only **Freight Manager** carries all three of the others.

Freight Sales

Quotes, and opens the files they sold. **Sees only their own**: a quotation where they are the salesperson, and a file where they are the salesperson or opened it themselves. Reads bills, containers, routing and declarations but does not touch them.

Operations Desk

Runs every file on the branch. Cargo, documents, bills of lading, containers, routing, charges, invoices and supplier bills. Reads the customs entry but does not lodge it.

Customs Broker

The declarations, in full: building an entry from the cargo, lodging it, answering a query, clearing it, and disbursing the duty onto the file. Maintains the tariff codes. **Reads the operations file without writing on it**, which is why clearing an entry stamps the file for them.

Freight Manager

All three of the above together, plus the right to delete, the whole **Configuration** menu, and the three figures kept off everybody else's screen: the standard cost on a rate card, an agent's profit share, and the agent share owed on a file.

> WHY IT MATTERS
> A salesperson seeing only their own files is a record rule, not a convention, so it holds on the list, in a search, in a report and through the interface. It is what lets you put a commission sheet in front of one salesperson without putting the whole branch's book in front of them.

Giving somebody a role

1. Open **Settings** > **Users & Companies** > **Users**.
2. Press **New**, or open the person who already has a login.
3. Type their **Name** and **Email Address**. The email address is the login.
4. On the **Access Rights** tab, find **Freight Forwarding** and pick one of the four roles.

5. Give them **Invoicing** as well if they will raise invoices or book supplier bills.
6. Press **Save**, then **Send an Invitation Email**.

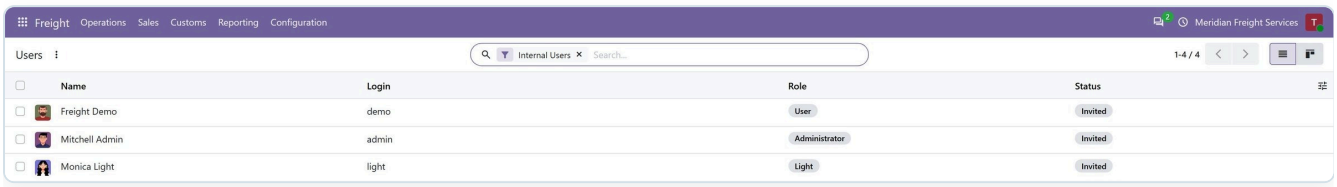


Figure 5. The user list. Open a person to set the Freight role on their Access Rights tab.

> **TIP**
> An overseas agent or a customer should never be given one of these four roles. They are internal roles. If somebody outside the business needs to see a file, send them the document or the arrival notice.

What each role can see

	Sales	Operations	Broker	Manager
Quote, send, win, lose	**Own only**	Read	Read	**All**
Open and run a file	**Own only**	**All**	Read	**All**
Cargo lines	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Document checklist	No	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Bills, containers, routing	Read	**Yes**	Read	**Yes**
Charges, invoices, supplier bills	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Customs declarations	Read	Read	**Yes**	**Yes**
Standard cost on a rate card	No	No	No	**Yes**
Agent profit share, and the share on a file	No	No	No	**Yes**
The office's customs licence number	No	No	**Yes**	**Yes**
Configuration menu	No	No	No	**Yes**
Deleting anything	No	No	No	**Yes**

> **TIP**
> Cost rates and the gross profit on a file are **not** hidden from the operations desk or from sales. If a figure must not appear on a screen a customer can see, the rule to lean on is the salesperson's own record rule, or a second user account, not a field permission that does not exist.

Where the database carries more than one company, the records of the other companies are filtered out by rule as well: a user in Nairobi does not see Mombasa's files unless the Mombasa company is among their allowed companies.

CHAPTER 3

Setting it up

Half a day, once. Everything in this chapter is under **Configuration** and only a Freight Manager can change it. Get the charge codes and the tariff codes right and the rest of the system more or less fills itself in.

In this chapter

- Settings
- Offices
- Ports and airports
- Trade lanes
- Agents
- Charge codes
- Tariff codes
- Container types
- Document types
- The order to do it in

Settings

Open **Configuration** > **Settings**. Eight figures, and every one of them is a decision somebody in the business has already made; you are only writing it down.

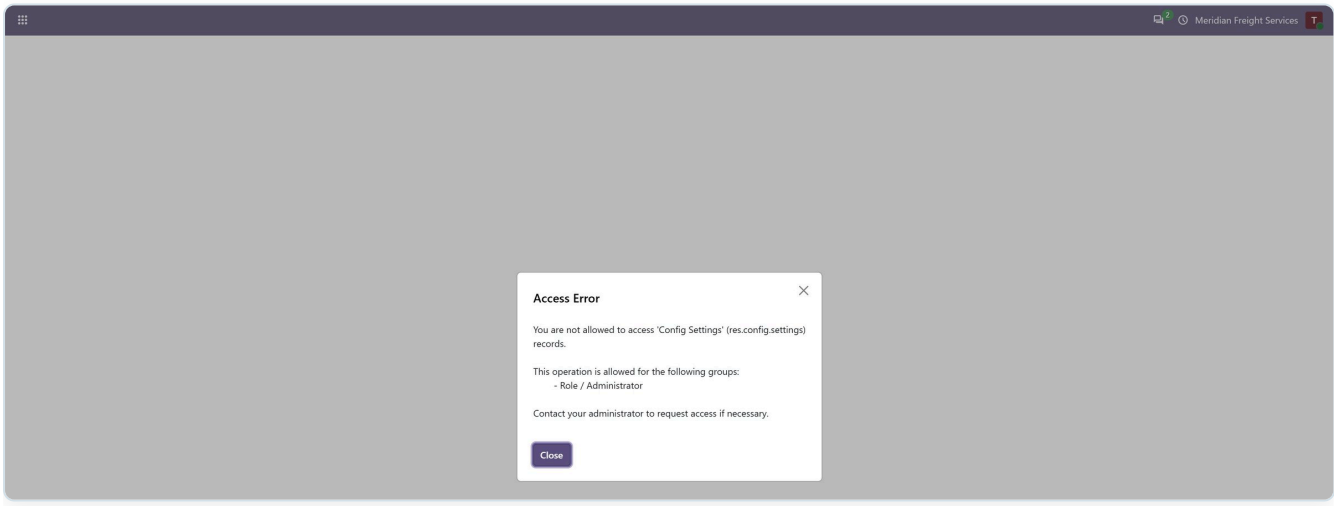


Figure 6. The settings page. These are company wide, so a second office on the same company uses the same divisors.

Setting	Usual	What it decides
Air Volumetric Divisor	6000	Cubic centimetres to the kilo on air freight. Six thousand is the IATA figure. Some carriers rate on five thousand, and on a light shipment the difference is real money.
Road Volumetric Divisor	3000	The same thing for groupage road freight.
LCL Weight or Measure	1000	Kilos to the cubic metre on sea groupage. A tonne to the cube, and the greater of the two is charged.

Setting	Usual	What it decides
Minimum Margin	15%	The floor a file is measured against when its trade lane has no target of its own. Under it, the file and the quotation are flagged.
Documents Before Delivery	On	Refuses to mark a file delivered while a required document is still outstanding.
Chase Unbilled Files After	14 days	How long a file may carry cost with no invoice out before the salesperson gets an activity about it.
Chase Documents Before Arrival	5 days	How far ahead of the ETA the customer is emailed about documents that have not come in.
Standard Import VAT	16%	Used on a tariff line when its HS code carries no rate of its own, so a new commodity does not quietly clear at zero.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> The divisors live here rather than in the code because the quotation and the file both have to answer the chargeable weight question the same way. If they disagree, the invoice does not match what was quoted, and that argument is always lost.

Offices

Configuration > **Offices**. An office is a branch: its code is the first part of every file number it opens, and it decides whether that branch may lodge a customs entry at all.

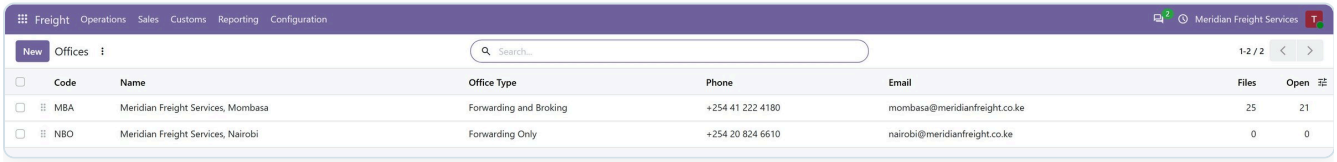


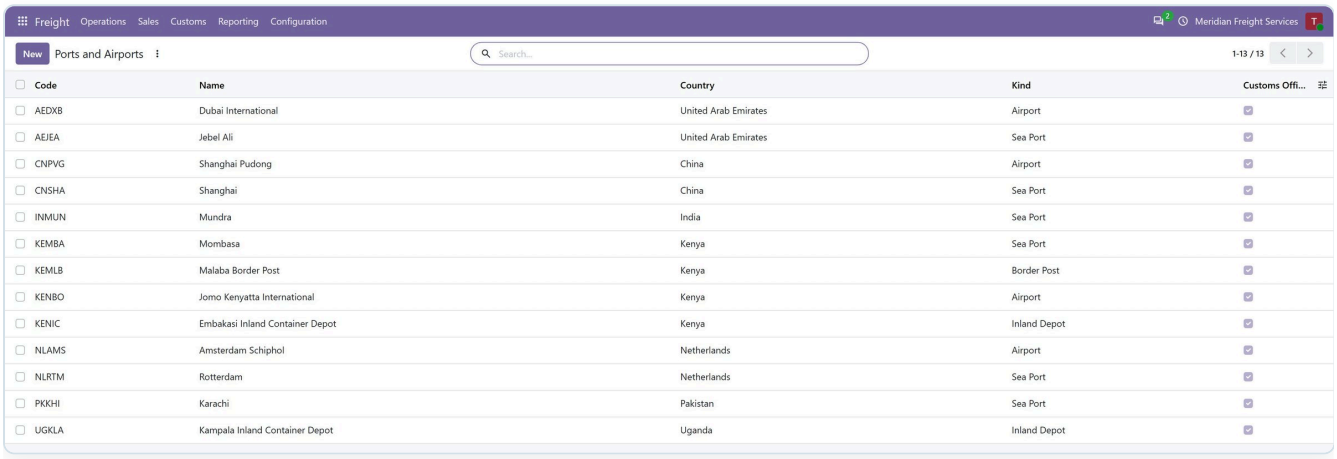
Figure 7. Two offices. Mombasa forwards and clears; Nairobi forwards only.

1. Press **New**.
2. Type the **Name** and a short **Code**, three letters is ideal. The code goes on the front of every file number, so MBA and not MOMBASA OFFICE.
3. Set **Office Type**: **Forwarding Only**, **Customs Broker Only** or **Forwarding and Broking**.
4. If it clears, put the **Customs Licence Number** on. It prints on every entry worksheet the office files.
5. Set the **Address**, which is what appears on the documents, and the **Sales Journal** and **Purchase Journal** the office's invoices and supplier bills belong in.
6. Press **Save**.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> A branch set to **Forwarding Only** cannot raise a declaration. Try it and the file says so by name. That is deliberate: a licence belongs to an office, and an entry filed under the wrong one is a problem with the authority, not with the software.

Ports and airports

Configuration > Ports & Airports. Sea ports, airports, border posts, rail terminals and inland depots all live in one list, each with its UN/LOCODE, its country and whether it is a place where goods can be entered.



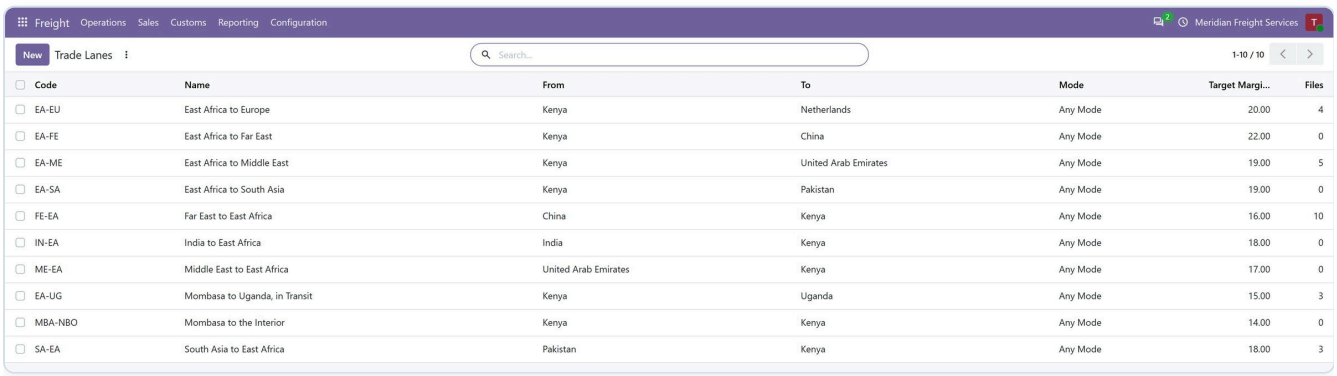
Code	Name	Country	Kind	Customs Offi...
AEDXB	Dubai International	United Arab Emirates	Airport	
AEJEA	Jebel Ali	United Arab Emirates	Sea Port	
CNPVG	Shanghai Pudong	China	Airport	
CNSHA	Shanghai	China	Sea Port	
INMUN	Mundra	India	Sea Port	
KEMBA	Mombasa	Kenya	Sea Port	
KEMLB	Malaba Border Post	Kenya	Border Post	
KENBO	Jomo Kenyatta International	Kenya	Airport	
KENIC	Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Kenya	Inland Depot	
NLAMS	Amsterdam Schiphol	Netherlands	Airport	
NLRTM	Rotterdam	Netherlands	Sea Port	
PKKHI	Karachi	Pakistan	Sea Port	
UGKLA	Kampala Inland Container Depot	Uganda	Inland Depot	

Figure 8. The places this branch works. Mombasa, the Embakasi depot, Jomo Kenyatta and the Malaba border post, with the load ports beyond them.

> **TIP**
>
> Put the inland points in as well as the sea ports. A container discharged at Mombasa and railed to the Embakasi depot is two legs, and the file is only honest if the second one exists.

Trade lanes

Configuration > Trade Lanes. A lane is a pair of countries and a target margin. A file picks its own lane from the loading and discharge points, so nobody has to remember to set it.



Code	Name	From	To	Mode	Target Margi...	Files
EA-EU	East Africa to Europe	Kenya	Netherlands	Any Mode	20.00	4
EA-FE	East Africa to Far East	Kenya	China	Any Mode	22.00	0
EA-ME	East Africa to Middle East	Kenya	United Arab Emirates	Any Mode	19.00	5
EA-SA	East Africa to South Asia	Kenya	Pakistan	Any Mode	19.00	0
FE-EA	Far East to East Africa	China	Kenya	Any Mode	16.00	10
IN-EA	India to East Africa	India	Kenya	Any Mode	18.00	0
ME-EA	Middle East to East Africa	United Arab Emirates	Kenya	Any Mode	17.00	0
EA-UG	Mombasa to Uganda, in Transit	Kenya	Uganda	Any Mode	15.00	3
MBA-NBO	Mombasa to the Interior	Kenya	Kenya	Any Mode	14.00	0
SA-EA	South Asia to East Africa	Pakistan	Kenya	Any Mode	18.00	3

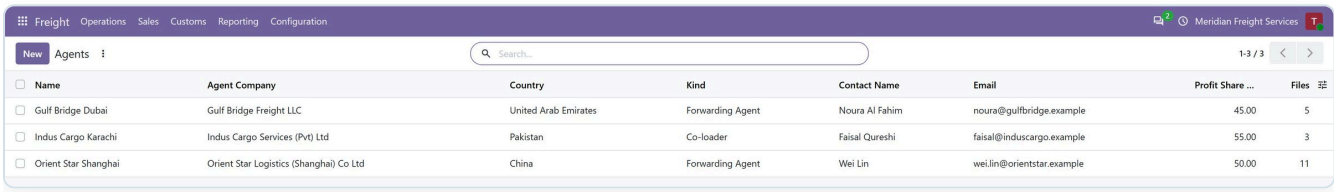
Figure 9. Lanes with their target margins. The Uganda transit corridor is thinner work than the Far East inbound, and the targets say so.

1. Press **New**, name the lane the way the business already talks about it, and give it a short code.
2. Set the **Origin Country** and **Destination Country**.
3. Leave **Mode** on **Any Mode** unless you really do price the same country pair differently by mode.
4. Set the **Target Margin (%)**. A file under it is flagged.

> **CAREFUL**
> Give each country pair one lane. Two lanes over the same pair make the match between them arbitrary, and the gross profit report then splits one lane's business across two rows.

Agents

Configuration > Agents. The overseas end: a forwarding agent, a co-loader, an NVOCC, a customs broker or a haulier, with the lanes they cover and the share of the profit they keep on business they nominate.



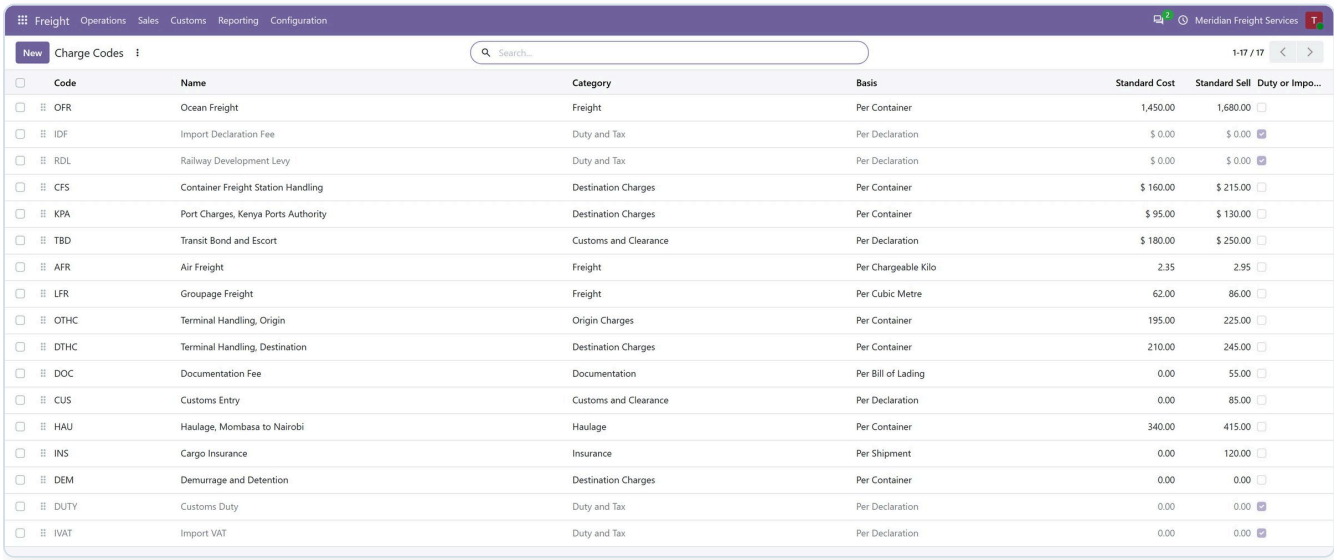
Name	Agent Company	Country	Kind	Contact Name	Email	Profit Share ...	Files
Gulf Bridge Dubai	Gulf Bridge Freight LLC	United Arab Emirates	Forwarding Agent	Noura Al Fahim	noura@gulfbridge.example	45.00	5
Indus Cargo Karachi	Indus Cargo Services (Pvt) Ltd	Pakistan	Co-loader	Faisal Qureshi	faisal@induscargo.example	55.00	3
Orient Star Shanghai	Orient Star Logistics (Shanghai) Co Ltd	China	Forwarding Agent	Wei Lin	wei.lin@orientstar.example	50.00	11

Figure 10. Three agents with the lanes they work.

When a file is marked as nominated by an agent, the share owed to them is worked out from the rate on their record. If the file's lane is not one the agent covers, the file refuses the nomination and names the lane, which is usually a sign the lane on the file is wrong rather than the agent.

Charge codes

Configuration > Charge Codes. The rate card. Each code carries a category, the basis it is charged on, the product and tax behind it, and the standard cost and sell.



Code	Name	Category	Basis	Standard Cost	Standard Sell	Duty or Impo...
OFR	Ocean Freight	Freight	Per Container	1,450.00	1,680.00	
IDF	Import Declaration Fee	Duty and Tax	Per Declaration	$ 0.00	$ 0.00	☑
RDL	Railway Development Levy	Duty and Tax	Per Declaration	$ 0.00	$ 0.00	☑
CFS	Container Freight Station Handling	Destination Charges	Per Container	$ 160.00	$ 215.00	
KPA	Port Charges, Kenya Ports Authority	Destination Charges	Per Container	$ 95.00	$ 130.00	
TBD	Transit Bond and Escort	Customs and Clearance	Per Declaration	$ 180.00	$ 250.00	
AFR	Air Freight	Freight	Per Chargeable Kilo	2.35	2.95	
LFR	Groupage Freight	Freight	Per Cubic Metre	62.00	86.00	
OTHC	Terminal Handling, Origin	Origin Charges	Per Container	195.00	225.00	
DTHC	Terminal Handling, Destination	Destination Charges	Per Container	210.00	245.00	
DOC	Documentation Fee	Documentation	Per Bill of Lading	0.00	55.00	
CUS	Customs Entry	Customs and Clearance	Per Declaration	0.00	85.00	
HAU	Haulage, Mombasa to Nairobi	Haulage	Per Container	340.00	415.00	
INS	Cargo Insurance	Insurance	Per Shipment	0.00	120.00	
DEM	Demurrage and Detention	Destination Charges	Per Container	0.00	0.00	
DUTY	Customs Duty	Duty and Tax	Per Declaration	0.00	0.00	☑
IVAT	Import VAT	Duty and Tax	Per Declaration	0.00	0.00	☑

Figure 11. The charge codes. Basis is the column that does the work: it is how a quantity gets onto a charge line without anybody retyping a tonnage.

Basis	Quantity taken from the file
Per Shipment	One. A flat charge on the file.
Per Container	The number of containers on the file.
Per TEU	The TEU total, so a forty foot box counts twice.
Per Chargeable Kilo	The chargeable weight, which is the greater of actual and volumetric.
Per Gross Kilo	The gross weight as loaded.
Per Cubic Metre	The volume of the cargo.
Per Bill of Lading	The number of live bills on the file.
Per Declaration	The number of customs entries on the file.

KENYA

Set up the KRA levies as charge codes of their own with **Duty and Tax** ticked: the Import Declaration Fee and the Railway Development Levy, alongside Customs Duty and Import VAT. A charge marked that way is recharged at cost and never counted as forwarding revenue, which keeps the gross profit on a file honest even when forty thousand dollars of duty has passed across it.

Tariff codes

Configuration > Tariff Codes. The HS codes you actually handle, each with its duty rate, excise rate and VAT rate, and whether it is restricted.

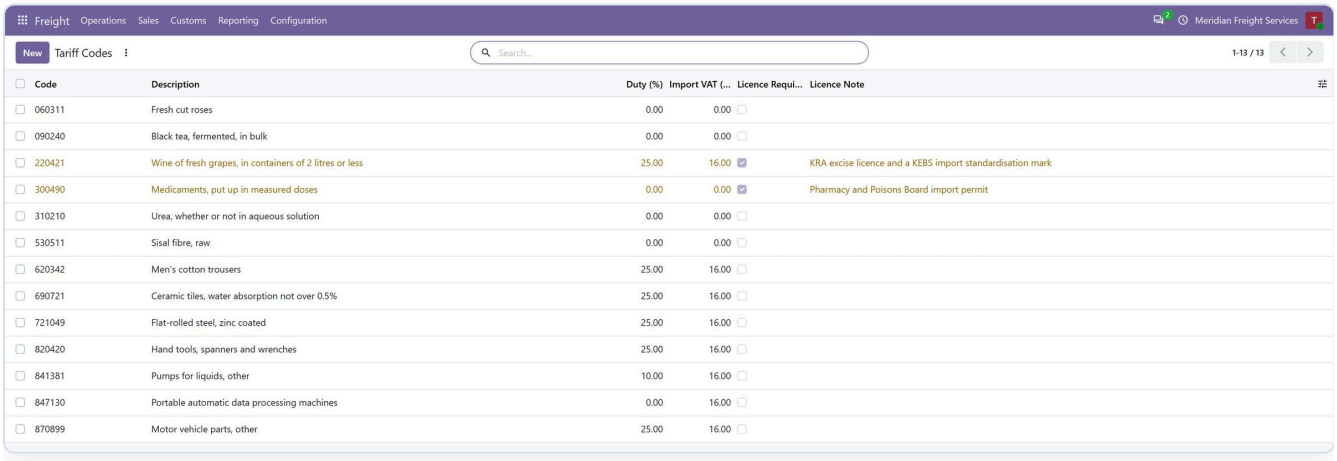


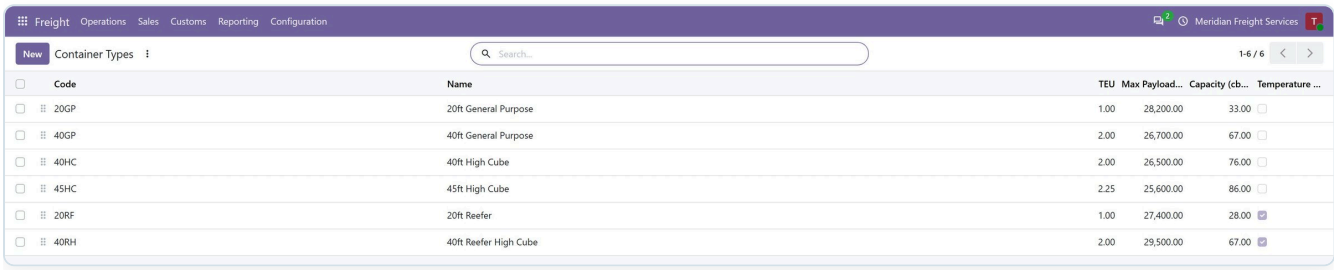
Figure 12. The commodities this branch sees, at EAC rates. Fertiliser and medicaments are exempt; wine carries excise on top of the duty and cannot clear without a licence.

1. Press **New** and type the **Code** and the **Description**.
2. Set **Duty (%)**, **Excise (%)** and **VAT (%)**. Leave VAT empty to fall back on the standard rate in the settings.
3. Tick **Restricted** if the commodity needs a permit, and write which permit in **Licence Note**.

> **WHY IT MATTERS**
>
> A restricted line is what stops an entry clearing without a licence reference on it. The note is there so the clerk who meets the refusal knows which authority to go to, instead of ringing the broker to ask.

Container types

Configuration > Container Types. The box sizes you book, with the TEU factor, the maximum payload, the internal capacity and whether it is a reefer.

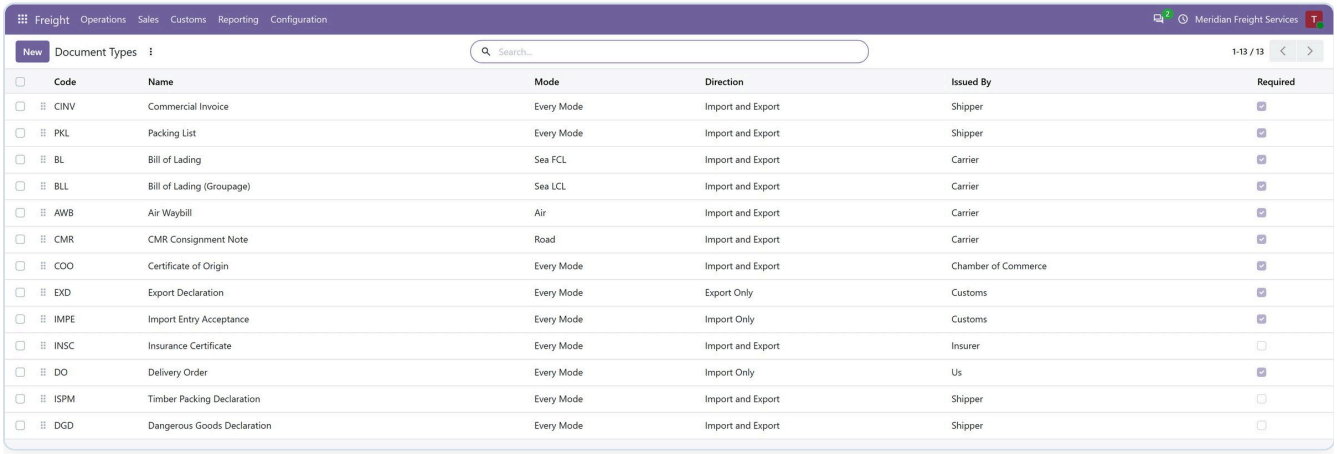


Code	Name	TEU	Max Payload...	Capacity (cb...	Temperature ...
20GP	20ft General Purpose	1.00	28,200.00	33.00	
40GP	40ft General Purpose	2.00	26,700.00	67.00	
40HC	40ft High Cube	2.00	26,500.00	76.00	
45HC	45ft High Cube	2.25	25,600.00	86.00	
20RF	20ft Reefer	1.00	27,400.00	28.00	☑
40RH	40ft Reefer High Cube	2.00	29,500.00	67.00	☑

Figure 13. Six types. The payload and the capacity are what the system checks a booking against.

Document types

Configuration > Document Types. The checklist. Each document says which mode and direction it applies to, who has to produce it, and whether it is required.



Code	Name	Mode	Direction	Issued By	Required
CINV	Commercial Invoice	Every Mode	Import and Export	Shipper	☑
PKL	Packing List	Every Mode	Import and Export	Shipper	☑
BL	Bill of Lading	Sea FCL	Import and Export	Carrier	☑
BLL	Bill of Lading (Groupage)	Sea LCL	Import and Export	Carrier	☑
AWB	Air Waybill	Air	Import and Export	Carrier	☑
CMR	CMR Consignment Note	Road	Import and Export	Carrier	☑
COO	Certificate of Origin	Every Mode	Import and Export	Chamber of Commerce	☑
EXD	Export Declaration	Every Mode	Export Only	Customs	☑
IMPE	Import Entry Acceptance	Every Mode	Import Only	Customs	☑
INSC	Insurance Certificate	Every Mode	Import and Export	Insurer	☐
DO	Delivery Order	Every Mode	Import Only	Us	☑
ISPM	Timber Packing Declaration	Every Mode	Import and Export	Shipper	☐
DGD	Dangerous Goods Declaration	Every Mode	Import and Export	Shipper	☐

Figure 14. Thirteen document types. A file picks up the ones that match its mode and direction the moment it is created.

Issued By is the first question when a document is late, so it is on the record rather than in somebody's head: the shipper, the consignee, us, the carrier, customs, a chamber of commerce or an insurer.

> **TIP**
>
> Be careful with **Required**. With **Documents Before Delivery** switched on in the settings, a required document that has not arrived will stop the file being marked delivered. That is exactly what you want for an original bill of lading, and a nuisance for a packing list.

The order to do it in

- [ ] Settings: the three divisors and the minimum margin.
- [ ] Offices, with their codes, licences and journals.
- [ ] Ports, including the inland depots and border posts.
- [ ] Trade lanes, one per country pair, with target margins.
- [ ] Container types, if you move boxes.
- [ ] Charge codes, with the duty and tax codes marked.
- [ ] Tariff codes for the commodities you actually handle.
- [ ] Document types, and which of them are genuinely required.
- [ ] Agents, last, because they refer to the lanes.

CHAPTER 4

Quoting

A quotation carries a cost and a sell on every line, so you know the margin before you send it rather than after the file closes. Win it and the file opens with the rates already on it.

In this chapter

- Raising a quotation
- The rate lines
- Margin and the lane target
- Sending it
- Won, and what happens next
- Lost, and why
- Expiry
- Why we lose

Raising a quotation

Open **Sales** > **Quotations** and press **New**.

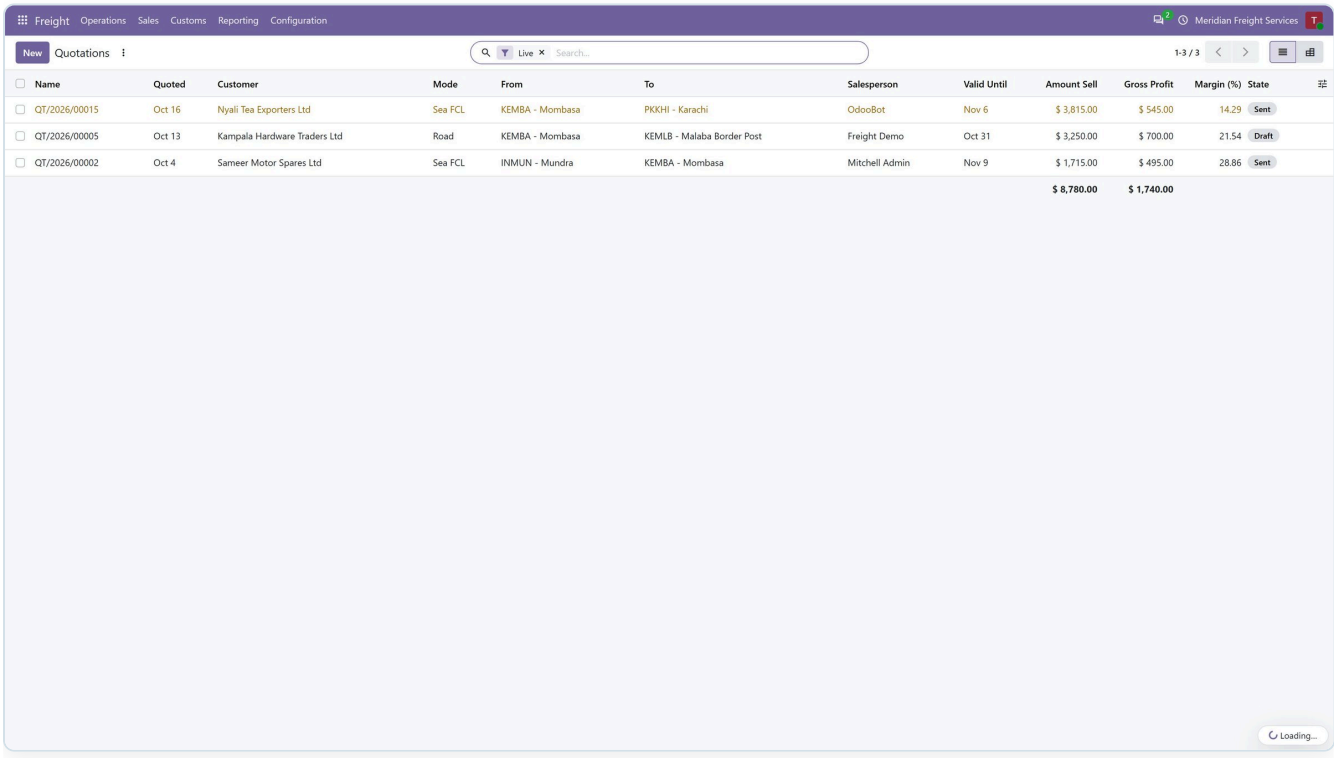


Figure 15. The quotation list. Margin is on the list, so a thin one is visible before anybody opens it.

1. Pick the **Customer**, and type the **Contact** name if the enquiry came from a particular person.
2. Set **Mode** and **Direction**.
3. Set **From** and **To**. The **Trade Lane** fills itself in from the two countries.

4. Fill in what you know about the cargo: **Pieces**, **Gross Weight**, **Volume** and the **Commodity**. The **Chargeable Weight** works itself out from the mode.
5. Set the **Validity Date** and the **Transit Time** in days. Both print on the quotation and both get asked about.
6. Add the rate lines, below.
7. Press **Save**.

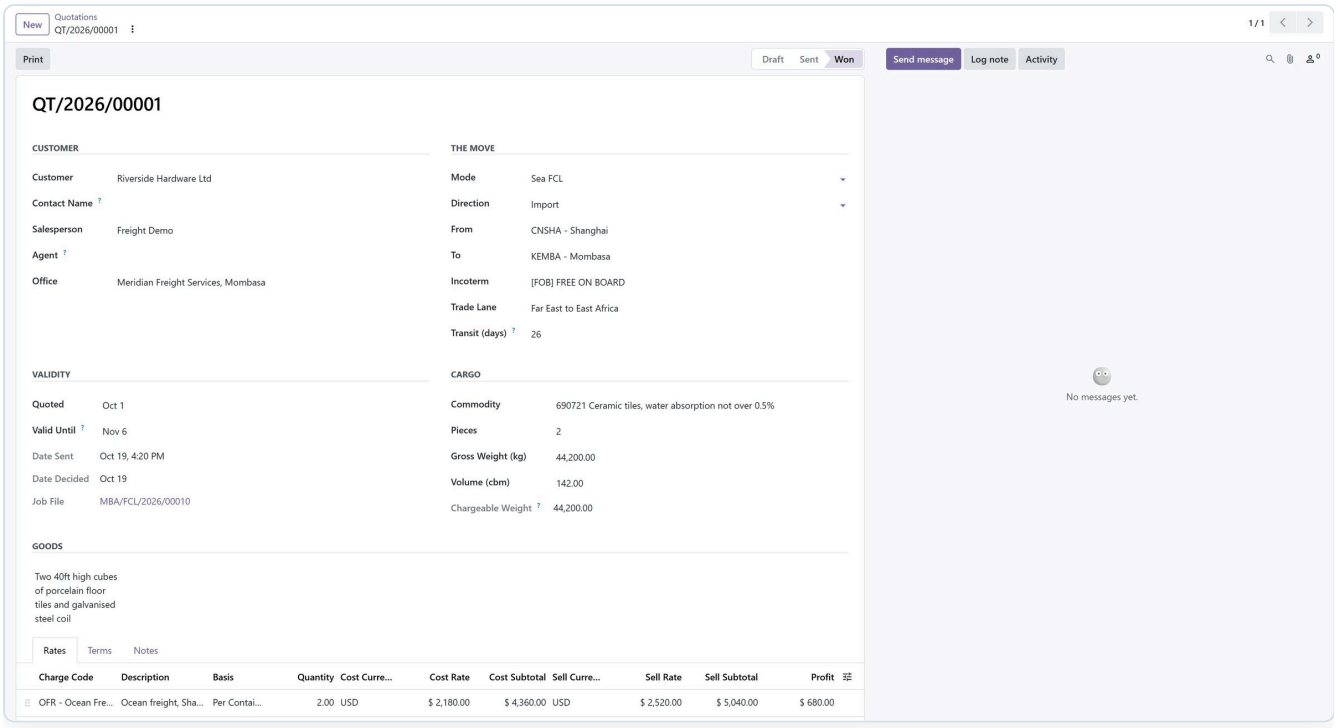


Figure 16. A full container quotation, Shanghai to Mombasa. Six lines, each with what it costs us and what it sells for.

The rate lines

Each line is one charge, with two sides to it.

1. On the **Rates** tab press **Add a line**.
2. Pick the **Charge Code**. The description, the basis and the standard rates come across with it.
3. Check the **Basis** and the **Quantity**. Two forty foot boxes is a quantity of two on a per container line, and the chargeable weight on a per kilo line.
4. Type the **Cost Rate** and the **Sell Rate**, each in its own currency if they differ.
5. Repeat for every charge the customer will see. A quotation that leaves out terminal handling is not cheaper, it is wrong.

> **TIP**
>
> Put the zero cost lines in too: documentation and the customs entry often cost nothing to buy and sell for real money. Leaving them off understates both the price and the margin.

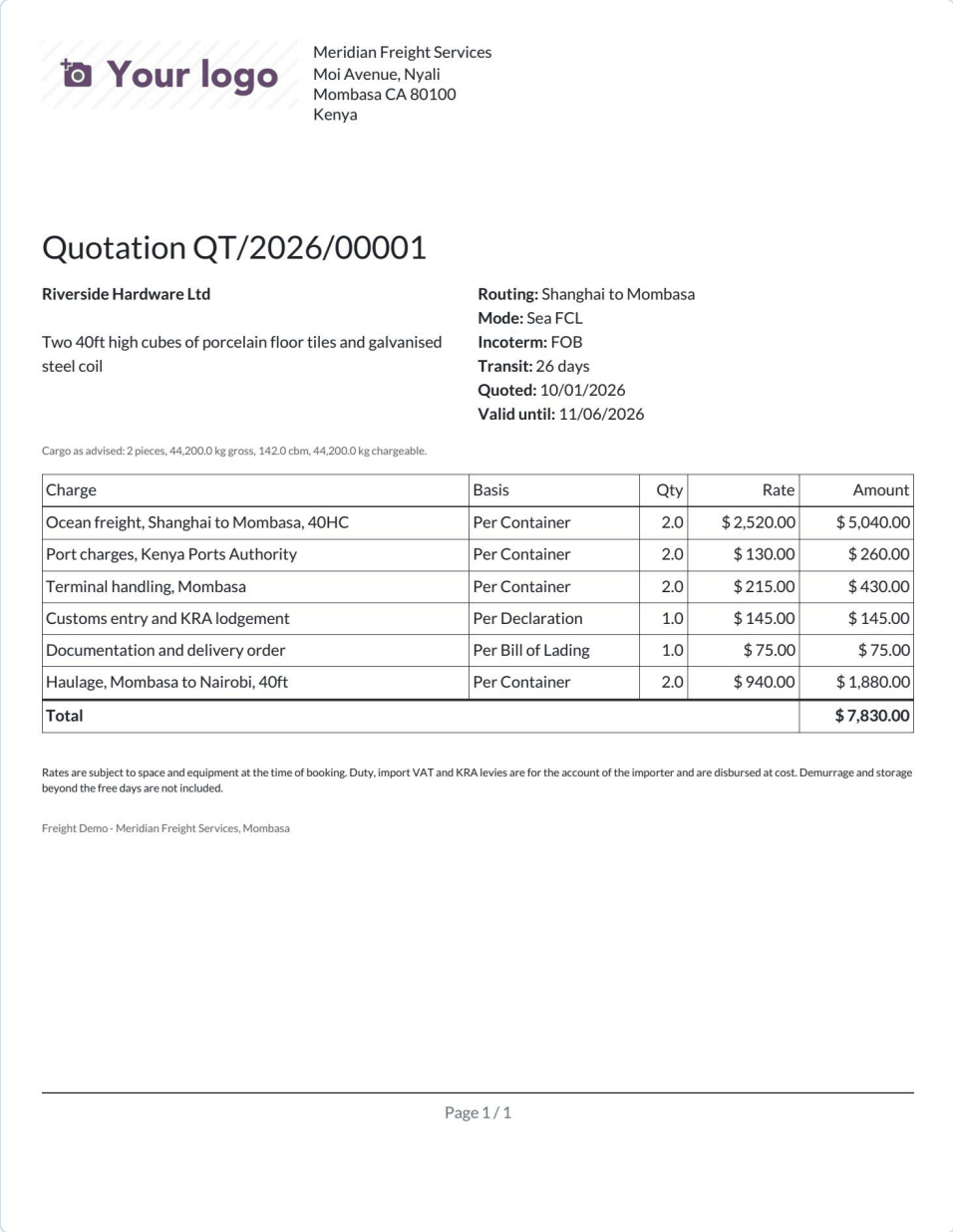
Margin and the lane target

As you type, **Amount Cost**, **Amount Sell**, **Gross Profit** and **Margin (%)** keep up. If the margin falls below the target on the trade lane, or below the company minimum when the lane has no target, the quotation is flagged as under target.

> WHY IT MATTERS
> The flag is a prompt, not a block. There are good reasons to quote under target: a first shipment from a customer who will bring twenty, or a backhaul that would otherwise run empty. The point is that the decision is taken in front of the number rather than discovered three months later in the gross profit report.

Sending it

1. Press **Print** to produce the PDF.
2. Check the validity date and the transit time on it.
3. Press **Send**. The quotation moves to **Sent** and the date is recorded.



Your logo

Meridian Freight Services
Moi Avenue, Nyali
Mombasa CA 80100
Kenya

Quotation QT/2026/00001

Riverside Hardware Ltd

Two 40ft high cubes of porcelain floor tiles and galvanised steel coil

Routing: Shanghai to Mombasa
Mode: Sea FCL
Incoterm: FOB
Transit: 26 days
Quoted: 10/01/2026
Valid until: 11/06/2026

Cargo as advised: 2 pieces, 44,200.0 kg gross, 142.0 cbm, 44,200.0 kg chargeable.

Charge	Basis	Qty	Rate	Amount
Ocean freight, Shanghai to Mombasa, 40HC	Per Container	2.0	$ 2,520.00	$ 5,040.00
Port charges, Kenya Ports Authority	Per Container	2.0	$ 130.00	$ 260.00
Terminal handling, Mombasa	Per Container	2.0	$ 215.00	$ 430.00
Customs entry and KRA lodgement	Per Declaration	1.0	$ 145.00	$ 145.00
Documentation and delivery order	Per Bill of Lading	1.0	$ 75.00	$ 75.00
Haulage, Mombasa to Nairobi, 40ft	Per Container	2.0	$ 940.00	$ 1,880.00
Total				**$ 7,830.00**

Rates are subject to space and equipment at the time of booking. Duty, import VAT and KRA levies are for the account of the importer and are disbursed at cost. Demurrage and storage beyond the free days are not included.

Freight Demo - Meridian Freight Services, Mombasa

Page 1 / 1

Figure 17. The printed quotation. Only the sell side appears on it.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> The printed quotation shows the sell rates and the totals. It does not show cost or margin. Check anyway before anything goes out, because it is the one document in this system that is read by somebody who is deciding whether to give you the business.

Won, and what happens next

1. Open the quotation and press **Won, Open a File**.
2. The system opens a job file, copies the rates onto it as charges, and takes you straight to it.
3. The quotation shows which file it became; the file shows which quotation it came from.

> **TIP**
>
> The quantities on the new file's charges are recalculated against what is actually on the file. Quote two containers and ship one, and the per container lines come down to one. The rates stay exactly as quoted; only the quantities follow the cargo.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> A quotation whose validity date has passed cannot be won. The system names the date and asks you to requote. That is the whole point of a validity date: a rate from six weeks ago is not a rate.

Lost, and why

1. Press **Lost**.
2. Pick a **Lost Reason**: beaten on rate, transit time, service or schedule, credit terms, no answer, the shipment did not happen, or other.
3. Add a line of detail in **Lost Note**. "Beaten by a direct service, nine days quicker" is worth something in three months; "too expensive" is not.

Expiry

A quotation still sitting in **Draft** or **Sent** past its validity date is moved to **Expired** by a nightly job. It is not lost, because nobody said no; it simply is not a live rate any more. Expired quotations stay out of the lost analysis for exactly that reason.

Why we lose

Sales > Why We Lose groups the lost quotations by reason, with what each reason cost in revenue and in gross profit.

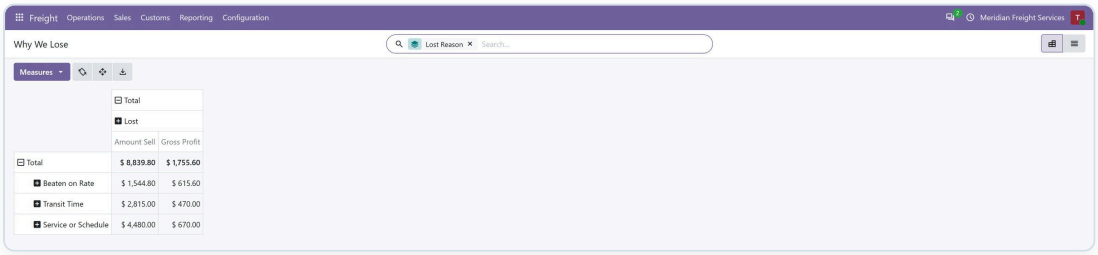


Figure 18. Lost business by reason. Service and schedule cost more here than rate did, which is a conversation with the carrier rather than a reason to drop the price.

> **WHY IT MATTERS**
>
> Every forwarder believes they lose on rate. Measured over a quarter it is often transit time or a credit limit, and those are fixed in different places and by different people. The report is only as good as the reasons people pick, which is why the reason is asked for at the moment the quotation is marked lost rather than at the end of the month.

CHAPTER 5

The job file

The centre of the system. Open it when the booking is confirmed, keep it honest while the cargo moves, and close it when the money is in. Everything else in this guide hangs off this chapter.

In this chapter

- Opening a file
- The form
- The cargo
- Chargeable weight
- The document checklist
- The seven states
- Booking it
- Sailed, arrived, cleared, delivered
- The arrival notice
- Closing it
- Cancelling it

Opening a file

Most files open themselves, from a quotation marked won. To open one from scratch, go to **Operations** > **Job Files** and press **New**.

1. Set the **Mode** and the **Direction** first. The mode decides the numbering and cannot be changed after the file is booked.
2. Pick the **Office**. Its code becomes the front of the file number.
3. Pick the **Customer**, the one the invoice goes to. On a nominated import that is often neither the shipper nor the consignee.
4. Type the **Customer Reference**, their purchase order or booking reference. Quote it on the invoice or it will not get paid.
5. Set the **Shipper**, **Consignee** and **Notify Party**. Leave notify empty and the arrival notice goes to the consignee.
6. Set the **Port of Loading** and **Port of Discharge**. The **Trade Lane** follows from them.
7. Set the **Incoterm**. It decides who pays which leg, so it belongs on the file and on the bill.
8. If an overseas agent sent you the business, set the **Overseas Agent** and tick **Agent Nomination**.
9. Press **Save**. The file number is issued and the document checklist is laid out.

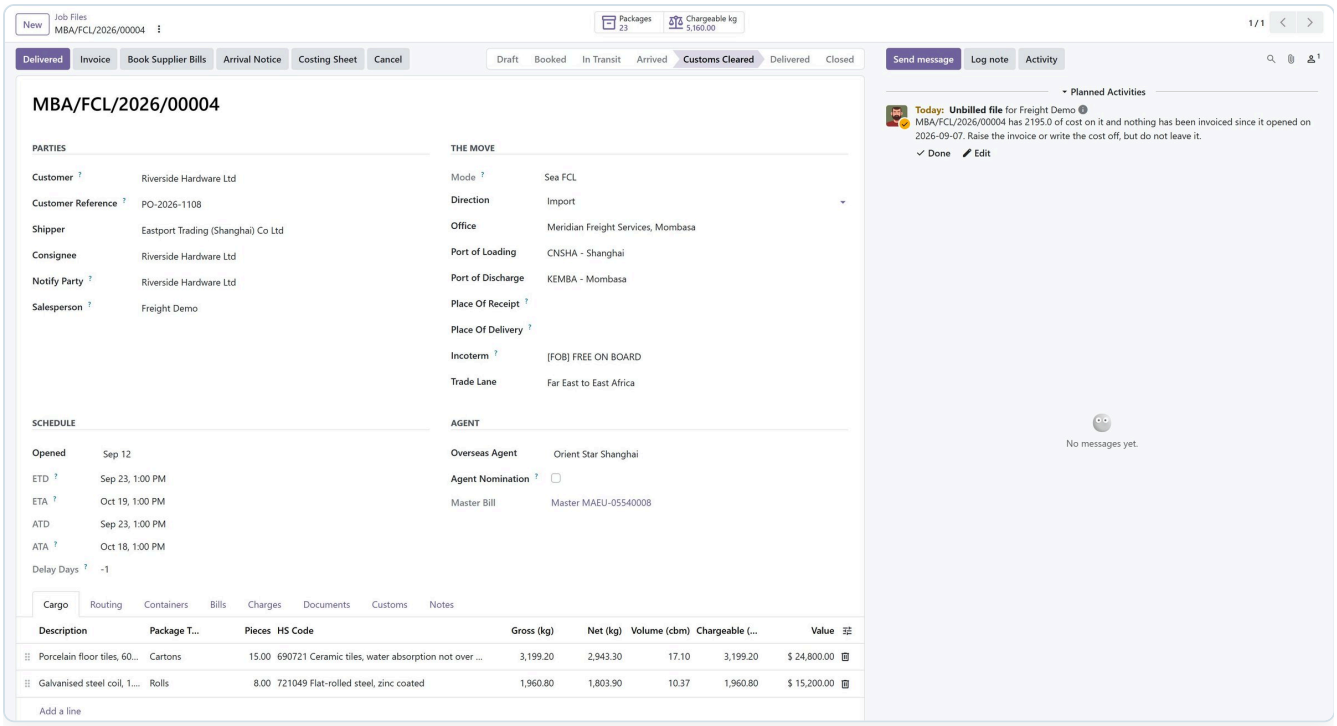


Figure 19. A full container import from Shanghai. The four panels are the parties, the move, the schedule and the agent; the tabs below carry everything else.

> **TIP**
>
> The schedule panel fills itself in. **ETD** comes from the first routing leg, **ETA** from the last, and **Delay Days** is the actual arrival against the estimate. Nobody types those four fields.

The cargo

On the **Cargo** tab, one line per commodity. Keep the commodities apart even when they travel in the same box, because the customs entry is built from these lines and duty is charged per tariff code.

1. Press **Add a line**.
2. Type the **Description** as it will read on the bill.
3. Pick the **Package Type**: cartons, pallets, crates, drums, bags, bundles, rolls or loose.
4. Pick the **HS Code**. Without one the cargo cannot be entered at customs.
5. Type the **Pieces**, the case **Length**, **Width** and **Height** in centimetres, the **Gross** and **Net** weight, and the **Value** from the commercial invoice.
6. Press **Save**.

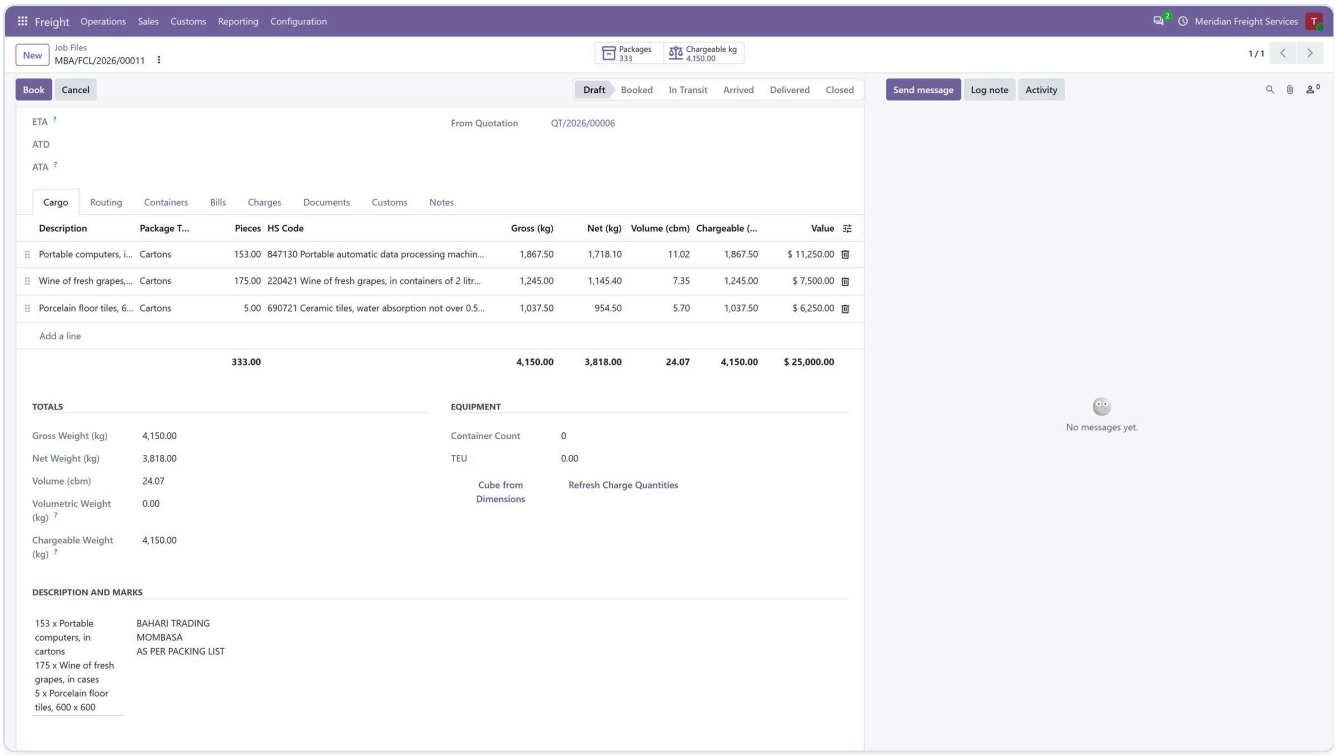


Figure 20. Three commodities on one file: computers, wine and tiles. They clear at three different rates, which is why they are three lines and not one.

The volume is worked out from the case sizes and the pieces. If you have the cubic from the shipper and not the case sizes, type the volume straight in. If you have corrected the dimensions and want the cubic redone, press **Cube from Dimensions**.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> The value on the cargo line is the figure the customs entry is built from, and the weights are what every per kilo rate on the file is applied to. A cargo tab filled in properly once removes two retypings later, each of which is a chance to be wrong by a decimal place.

Chargeable weight

Underneath the cargo the file keeps four figures: gross weight, net weight, volume and **Chargeable Weight**. The chargeable weight is the greater of the actual weight and the volume converted to kilos, and the conversion depends on the mode.

Mode	Volume becomes	So the file is rated on
Air	Volume ÷ 6,000 cm^3 per kilo	Whichever is greater of actual and volumetric
Road	Volume ÷ 3,000 cm^3 per kilo	Whichever is greater of actual and volumetric
Sea LCL	1,000 kg per cubic metre	Weight or measure, whichever is greater
Sea FCL	Not converted	The container and the TEU

All three divisors are settings, because tariffs differ. Change them in one place and the quotation and the file agree again.

The document checklist

The moment a file is created it picks up every document type that applies to its mode and direction. The **Documents** tab is that checklist, with who has to produce each one and whether it is required.

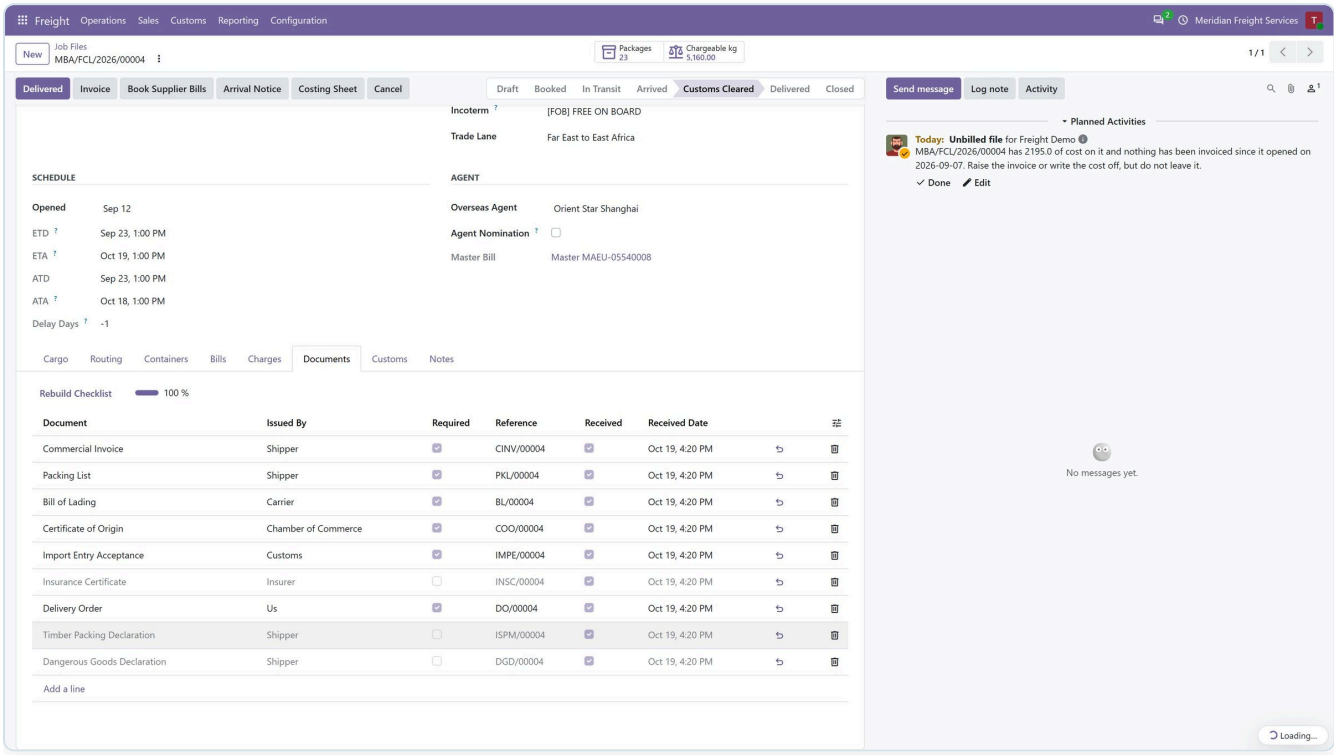


Figure 21. The checklist on an import. The percentage at the top of the file is how much of it has come in.

1. When a document arrives, press the tick at the end of its line to log it in, then attach the file to the message thread so it is on the record.
2. If it turns out to be wrong, press the arrow on the line to put it back on the outstanding list.
3. If you corrected the mode or the direction after the file was opened, press **Rebuild Checklist** to pick up the documents that now apply.

> CAREFUL
>
> With **Documents Before Delivery** switched on, a file will not be marked delivered while a required document is outstanding, and the refusal names them. Releasing cargo against a missing original is how a forwarder ends up liable for the goods, so resist the urge to switch the setting off; take the document off the required list instead if it genuinely is not needed.

The seven states

The bar across the top of the file is its life. It only ever moves by the buttons, never by typing into it, and each button carries a check.

State	Button to get there	What it refuses
Draft	no button	Where every file starts.

State	Button to get there	What it refuses
Booked	**Book**	No cargo on the file, or no loading and discharge point.
In Transit	**Sailed**	No routing. A full container file with no container. An air file with no master waybill.
Arrived	**Arrived**	A file that is not in transit.
Customs Cleared	**Customs Cleared**	A declaration on the file that is still open.
Delivered	**Delivered**	Required documents still outstanding.
Closed	**Close File**	Sell lines never invoiced, or supplier costs never booked.
Cancelled	**Cancel**	A closed file, a posted invoice on it, or an entry that has already cleared.

Booking it

1. Check the cargo is on and the two ports are set.
2. Press **Book**.
3. The file moves to **Booked** and a note goes on the thread with the pieces, the gross weight, the cubic and the chargeable weight as booked.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> That note is the snapshot of what you booked against. When the cargo turns up heavier than the shipper said, the thread shows what you were told and when, which is the difference between a conversation and an argument.

Sailed, arrived, cleared, delivered

1. When the vessel sails or the aircraft goes, press **Sailed**. If the first leg has no actual departure on it, the system puts today's on it.
2. When it berths or lands, press **Arrived**. The last leg's actual arrival is filled in, and if the file is late a note goes on the thread saying by how many days.
3. When the entry clears, press **Customs Cleared**. In practice the broker clears the entry and the file follows on its own.
4. When the cargo is handed over, press **Delivered**.

The arrival notice

Once a file has arrived, **Arrival Notice** emails the notify party, or the consignee if there is no notify party, with the vessel, the arrival date and what is still outstanding on the file.

CAREFUL

The button refuses to send on a file that has not arrived. An arrival notice for a vessel still at sea is how a forwarder loses a customer, and it is the sort of mistake that is only made once.

Closing it

A file is closed when the cargo is off your hands and the money has been dealt with on both sides.

1. Press **Close File**.
2. If any sell line has never been invoiced, the file refuses and says how many. Invoice them or take them off.
3. If any cost with a named supplier has no bill against it, the file refuses again. Book the bill or clear the accrual.
4. The file moves to **Closed** and today's date goes on as the closing date.

WHY IT MATTERS

Those two checks are the whole reason the profit figures in chapter 10 can be trusted. A file closed with an unbilled sell line overstates nothing and loses you revenue; a file closed with an unbooked cost overstates the profit, and the correction arrives a month later when the shipping line's invoice does.

Cancelling it

Cancel is for a booking that never happened. It refuses on a file carrying a posted invoice, on a file whose entry has already cleared customs, and on a file that has been closed: a closed file has been delivered, invoiced and costed, so it is credited and reopened rather than cancelled. A cancelled file can be sent back to **Draft**.

CHAPTER 6

Bills of lading and air waybills

The document the cargo moves against. One master per file and as many houses as the consolidation needs, each knowing whether it was issued as originals, a waybill or a telex release.

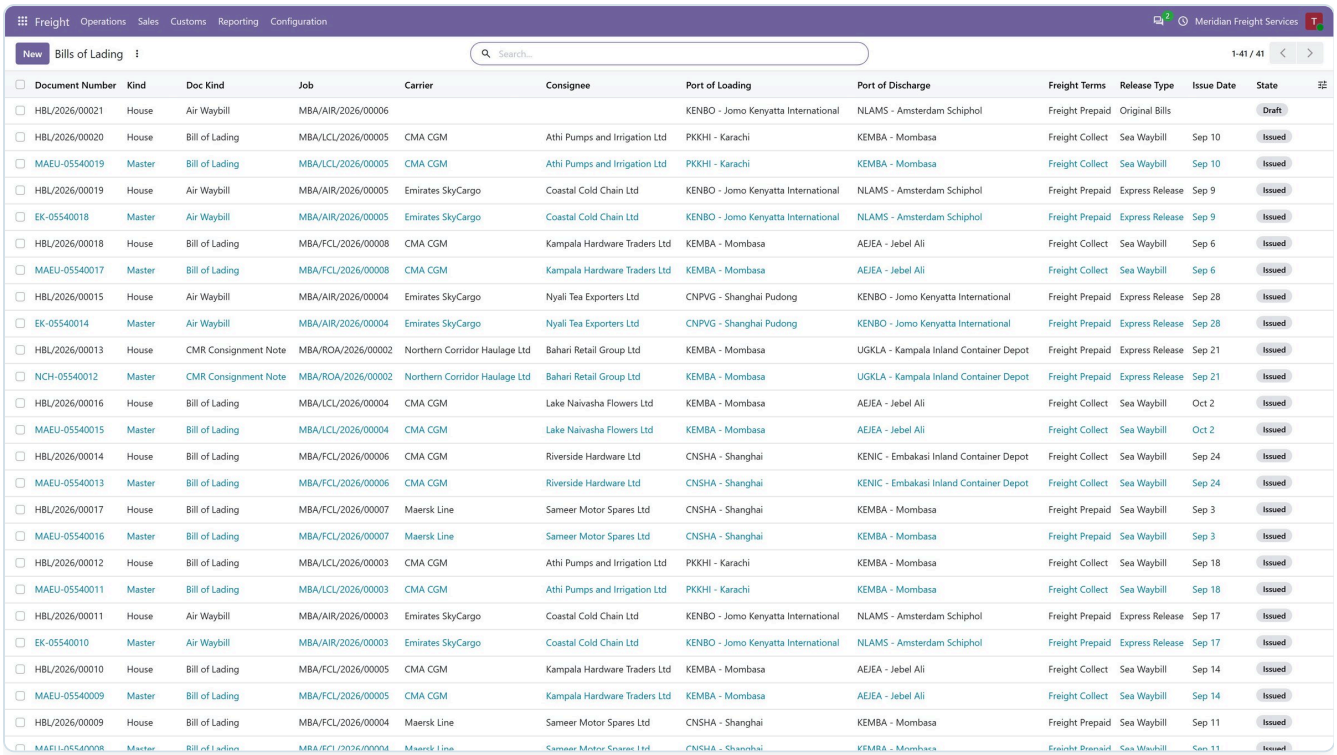
In this chapter

- Master and house
- Raising a bill
- Prepaid or collect
- How it was released
- Issuing it
- Releasing the cargo
- Surrendering originals
- Cancelling
- Printing it

Master and house

The master bill is between you and the carrier. The house bill is between you and your customer. On a straight file there is one of each; on a consolidation there is one master and a house for every shipper in the box.

Mode	Document	Carrier's number looks like
Sea FCL and LCL	Bill of Lading	MAEU-05540008
Air	Air Waybill	EK-05540002
Road	CMR Consignment Note	NCH-05540004



Document Number	Kind	Doc Kind	Job	Carrier	Consignee	Port of Loading	Port of Discharge	Freight Terms	Release Type	Issue Date	State
HBL/2026/00021	House	Air Waybill	MBA/AIR/2026/00006			KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Freight Prepaid	Original Bills		Draft
HBL/2026/00020	House	Bill of Lading	MBA/LCL/2026/00005	CMA CGM	Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 10	Issued
MAEU-05540019	Master	Bill of Lading	MBA/LCL/2026/00005	CMA CGM	Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 10	Issued
HBL/2026/00019	House	Air Waybill	MBA/AIR/2026/00005	Emirates SkyCargo	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Freight Prepaid	Express Release	Sep 9	Issued
EK-05540018	Master	Air Waybill	MBA/AIR/2026/00005	Emirates SkyCargo	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Freight Prepaid	Express Release	Sep 9	Issued
HBL/2026/00018	House	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00008	CMA CGM	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 6	Issued
MAEU-05540017	Master	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00008	CMA CGM	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 6	Issued
HBL/2026/00015	House	Air Waybill	MBA/AIR/2026/00004	Emirates SkyCargo	Nyali Tea Exporters Ltd	CNPVG - Shanghai Pudong	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	Freight Prepaid	Express Release	Sep 28	Issued
EK-05540014	Master	Air Waybill	MBA/AIR/2026/00004	Emirates SkyCargo	Nyali Tea Exporters Ltd	CNPVG - Shanghai Pudong	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	Freight Prepaid	Express Release	Sep 28	Issued
HBL/2026/00013	House	CMR Consignment Note	MBA/ROA/2026/00002	Northern Corridor Haulage Ltd	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container Depot	Freight Prepaid	Express Release	Sep 21	Issued
NCH-05540012	Master	CMR Consignment Note	MBA/ROA/2026/00002	Northern Corridor Haulage Ltd	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container Depot	Freight Prepaid	Express Release	Sep 21	Issued
HBL/2026/00016	House	Bill of Lading	MBA/LCL/2026/00004	CMA CGM	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Oct 2	Issued
MAEU-05540015	Master	Bill of Lading	MBA/LCL/2026/00004	CMA CGM	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Oct 2	Issued
HBL/2026/00014	House	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00006	CMA CGM	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 24	Issued
MAEU-05540013	Master	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00006	CMA CGM	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 24	Issued
HBL/2026/00017	House	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00007	Maersk Line	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Freight Prepaid	Sea Waybill	Sep 3	Issued
MAEU-05540016	Master	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00007	Maersk Line	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Freight Prepaid	Sea Waybill	Sep 3	Issued
HBL/2026/00012	House	Bill of Lading	MBA/LCL/2026/00003	CMA CGM	Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 18	Issued
MAEU-05540011	Master	Bill of Lading	MBA/LCL/2026/00003	CMA CGM	Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 18	Issued
HBL/2026/00011	House	Air Waybill	MBA/AIR/2026/00003	Emirates SkyCargo	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Freight Prepaid	Express Release	Sep 17	Issued
EK-05540010	Master	Air Waybill	MBA/AIR/2026/00003	Emirates SkyCargo	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Freight Prepaid	Express Release	Sep 17	Issued
HBL/2026/00010	House	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00005	CMA CGM	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 14	Issued
MAEU-05540009	Master	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00005	CMA CGM	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Freight Collect	Sea Waybill	Sep 14	Issued
HBL/2026/00009	House	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00004	Maersk Line	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Freight Prepaid	Sea Waybill	Sep 11	Issued
MAEU-05540008	Master	Bill of Lading	MBA/FCL/2026/00004	Maersk Line	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Freight Prepaid	Sea Waybill	Sep 11	Issued

Figure 22. The bill list. House bills carry your own numbering; masters carry the carrier's.

Raising a bill

1. Open the file and go to the **Bills** tab, or go to **Operations** > **Bills of Lading** and press **New**.
2. Pick the **Job** if you started from the list.
3. Set **Kind** to **Master** or **House**.
4. Set the **Document Kind**: bill of lading, air waybill or CMR note.
5. On a master, type the carrier's number into **Name**. On a house, leave it: your own numbering issues one on save.
6. Check the **Shipper**, **Consignee** and **Notify Party**. They come across from the file.
7. Check the **Description of Goods** and the **Marks and Numbers**. They print word for word.
8. Set **Freight Terms** and **Release Type**, below.
9. Press **Save**.

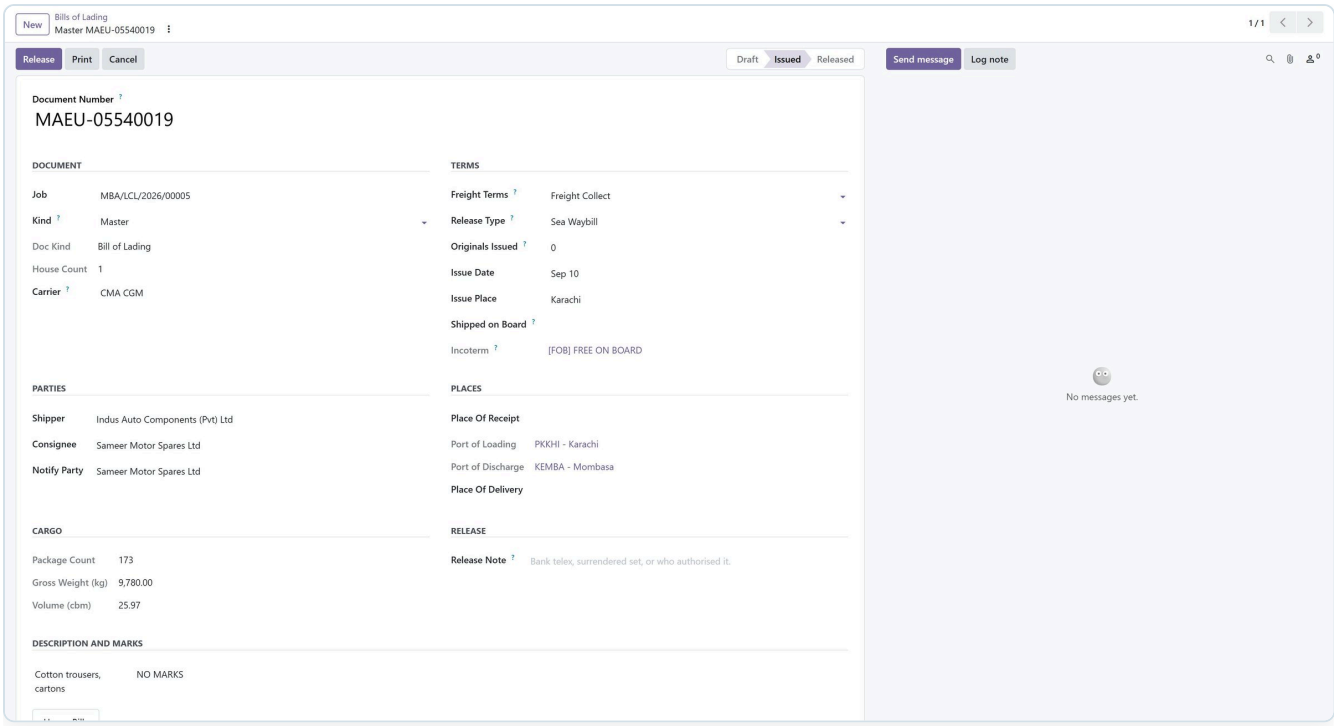


Figure 23. A master bill of lading. The weights and the piece count come off the file, so they cannot disagree with it.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> Keep the description to what the tariff and the letter of credit will accept. "General cargo" is quick to type and is the single most common reason a bank refuses a presentation.

Prepaid or collect

Freight Terms says who pays the carrier. **Freight Prepaid** means you do, at origin, and bill it on. **Freight Collect** means the consignee pays at destination. Both print on the document, and the incoterm on the file should agree with it.

How it was released

Release Type	What it means
Original Bills	A set of originals was printed and handed over. The cargo moves against one of them coming back.
Sea Waybill	Not a document of title. The named consignee takes the cargo on identification.
Telex Release	Originals were surrendered at origin and the release was wired to destination.
Express Release	No originals were ever issued.

On originals, set **Number of Originals**, which is three unless somebody says otherwise.

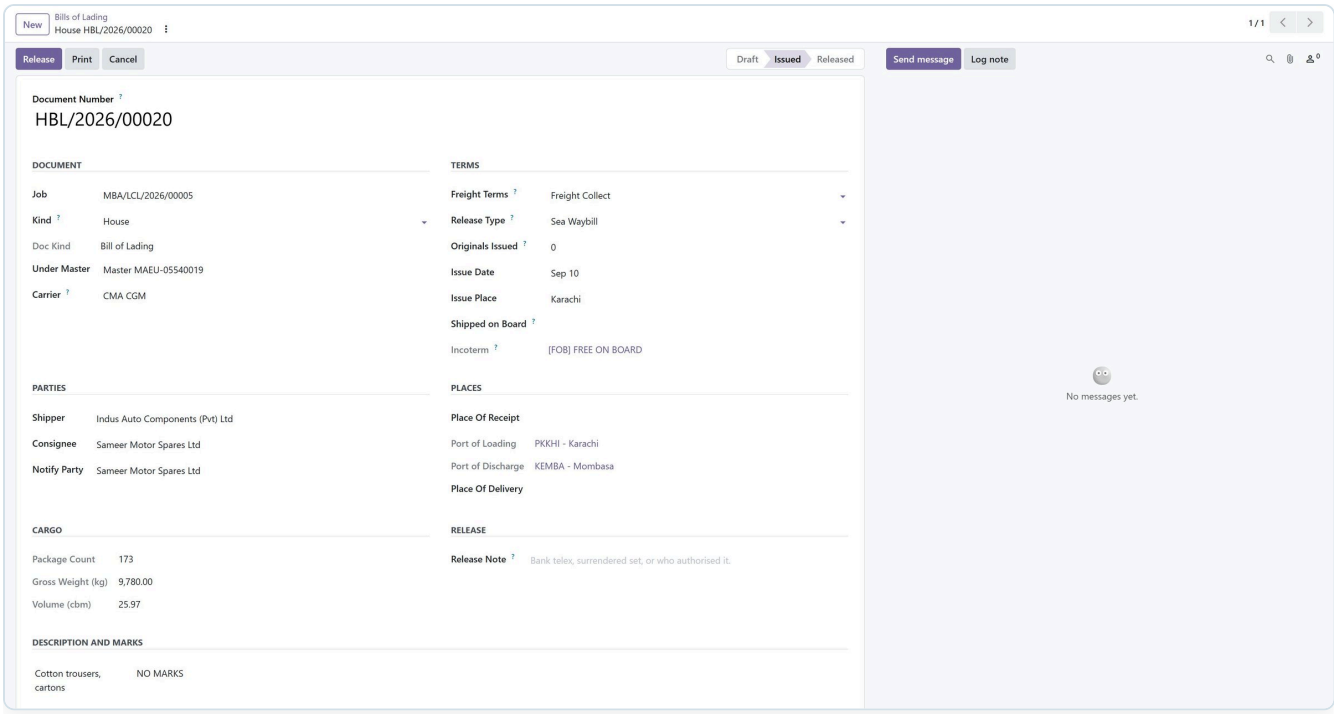


Figure 24. A house bill issued as a sea waybill, which is why there is no set of originals to chase.

Issuing it

1. Press **Issue**.
2. The bill moves to **Issued** and today's date goes on as the issue date.

> CAREFUL
>
> A house bill cannot be issued while there is no master behind it on the file. The system finds the live master and attaches the house to it; if there is not one it refuses, because a house bill issued with nothing behind it is a promise you cannot keep.
>
> A bill also needs a shipper and a consignee before it will issue.

Releasing the cargo

1. Press **Release**.
2. If the bill was issued as originals, record what you released it against in **Release Note** first: which original came back, or the telex reference, or the bank's authority.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> The system will not release an original bill without that note. Releasing cargo against a set of originals you cannot account for is the one mistake in freight forwarding that reliably ends in court, and the note is thirty seconds of typing against it.

Surrendering originals

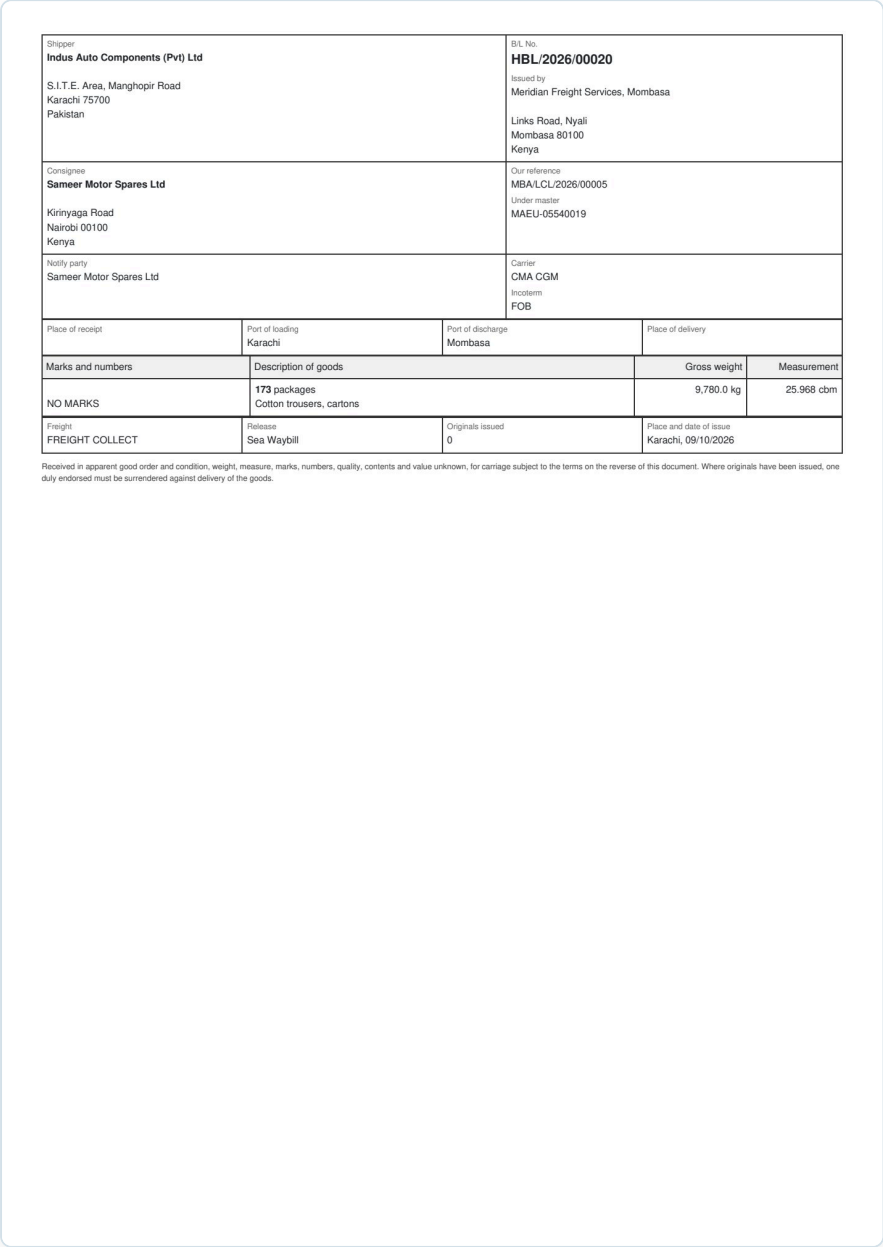
When the full set comes back, press **Originals Surrendered**. The bill moves to **Surrendered** and the number of originals outstanding goes to zero. On a waybill the button refuses, because there is no set to surrender.

Cancelling

Cancel works on a draft or an issued bill. It refuses on a released bill, because the cargo has gone against it and the consignee is holding the document: a released bill is corrected by issuing a new one. It refuses on a surrendered set after the fact. And a master will not cancel while live house bills still sit under it.

Printing it

Press **Print**. Shipper, consignee, notify party, the vessel and voyage, the ports, the marks, the description, the weights and the cubic, the freight terms and the release type.



Shipper
Indus Auto Components (Pvt) Ltd

S.I.T.E. Area, Manghopir Road
Karachi 75700
Pakistan

B/L No.
HBL/2026/00020
Issued by
Meridian Freight Services, Mombasa

Links Road, Nyali
Mombasa 80100
Kenya

Consignee
Sameer Motor Spares Ltd

Kirinyaga Road
Nairobi 00100
Kenya

Our reference
MBA/LCL/2026/00005
Under master
MAEU-05540019

Notify party
Sameer Motor Spares Ltd

Carrier
CMA CGM
Incoterm
FOB

Place of receipt	Port of loading	Port of discharge	Place of delivery
	Karachi	Mombasa	

Marks and numbers	Description of goods	Gross weight	Measurement
NO MARKS	**173** packages Cotton trousers, cartons	9,780.0 kg	25.968 cbm

Freight	Release	Originals issued	Place and date of issue
FREIGHT COLLECT	Sea Waybill	0	Karachi, 09/10/2026

Received in apparent good order and condition, weight, measure, marks, numbers, quality, contents and value unknown, for carriage subject to the terms on the reverse of this document. Where originals have been issued, one duly endorsed must be surrendered against delivery of the goods.

Figure 25. The printed bill of lading.

TIP

Print the house bill and read it beside the master before anything goes out. The two documents describe the same cargo and should not disagree about the weight, the marks or the number of packages. That five minute check catches most of what a terminal would otherwise catch for you, slowly and at a cost.

CHAPTER 7

Containers and routing

The box and the journey. A container number checked at the desk instead of at the gate at three in the morning, and a routing that shows where the cargo actually is rather than where it was sold to go.

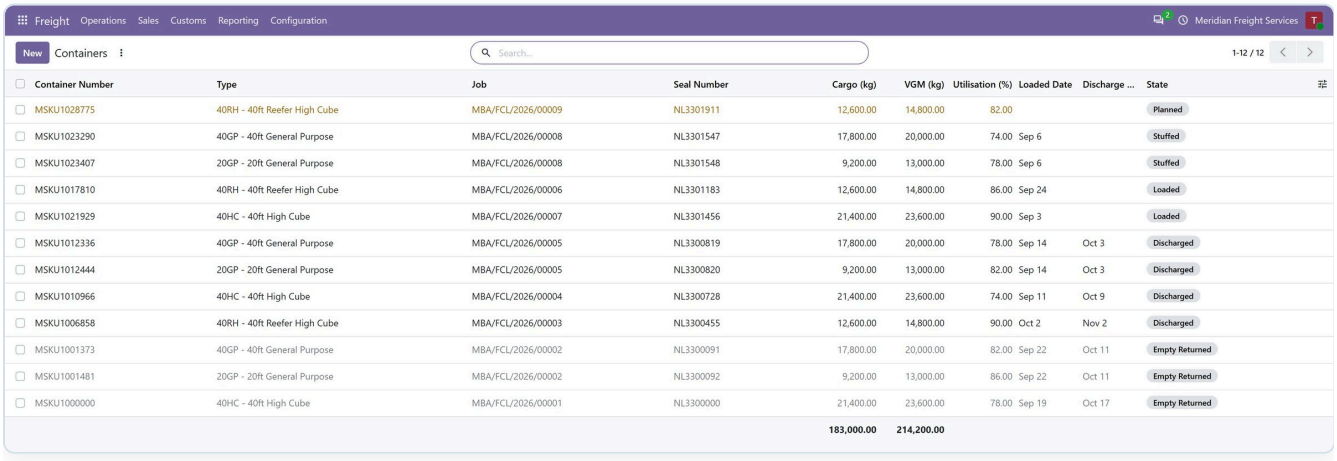
In this chapter

- Adding a container
- The number and its check digit
- Weights and the VGM
- Reefers
- The container's life
- Routing legs
- Departures and arrivals
- Delay
- Sailings and flights

Adding a container

From the file's **Containers** tab, or **Operations** > **Containers**.

1. Press **Add a line** and type the **Container Number**, four letters and seven digits.
2. Pick the **Container Type**. The TEU factor, the payload and the capacity come with it.
3. Type the **Seal Number** as soon as you have it.
4. Type the **Cargo Weight**. The tare comes from the type, and the verified gross mass follows from the two.
5. Type the **Stuffed Volume** if you want the utilisation worked out.



Container Number	Type	Job	Seal Number	Cargo (kg)	VGM (kg)	Utilisation (%)	Loaded Date	Discharge ...	State
MSKU1028775	40RH - 40ft Reefer High Cube	MBA/FCL/2026/00009	NL3301911	12,600.00	14,800.00	82.00			Planned
MSKU1023290	40GP - 40ft General Purpose	MBA/FCL/2026/00008	NL3301547	17,800.00	20,000.00	74.00	Sep 6		Stuffed
MSKU1023407	20GP - 20ft General Purpose	MBA/FCL/2026/00008	NL3301548	9,200.00	13,000.00	78.00	Sep 6		Stuffed
MSKU1017810	40RH - 40ft Reefer High Cube	MBA/FCL/2026/00006	NL3301183	12,600.00	14,800.00	86.00	Sep 24		Loaded
MSKU1021929	40HC - 40ft High Cube	MBA/FCL/2026/00007	NL3301456	21,400.00	23,600.00	90.00	Sep 3		Loaded
MSKU1012336	40GP - 40ft General Purpose	MBA/FCL/2026/00005	NL3300819	17,800.00	20,000.00	78.00	Sep 14	Oct 3	Discharged
MSKU1012444	20GP - 20ft General Purpose	MBA/FCL/2026/00005	NL3300820	9,200.00	13,000.00	82.00	Sep 14	Oct 3	Discharged
MSKU1010966	40HC - 40ft High Cube	MBA/FCL/2026/00004	NL3300728	21,400.00	23,600.00	74.00	Sep 11	Oct 9	Discharged
MSKU1006858	40RH - 40ft Reefer High Cube	MBA/FCL/2026/00003	NL3300455	12,600.00	14,800.00	90.00	Oct 2	Nov 2	Discharged
MSKU1001373	40GP - 40ft General Purpose	MBA/FCL/2026/00002	NL3300091	17,800.00	20,000.00	82.00	Sep 22	Oct 11	Empty Returned
MSKU1001481	20GP - 20ft General Purpose	MBA/FCL/2026/00002	NL3300092	9,200.00	13,000.00	86.00	Sep 22	Oct 11	Empty Returned
MSKU1000000	40HC - 40ft High Cube	MBA/FCL/2026/00001	NL3300000	21,400.00	23,600.00	78.00	Sep 19	Oct 17	Empty Returned
				183,000.00	214,200.00				

Figure 26. The container list across every file: number, seal, type, VGM and where each box has got to.

The number and its check digit

A container number is four letters and seven digits, and the last digit is a check digit calculated from the rest under ISO 6346. Type one in wrong and the system refuses it immediately, telling you what the last digit

should have been.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> A wrong container number is not found until the box is at a gate, a terminal or a customs entry, and by then it is somebody else's problem to fix at your cost. Checking it at the moment of typing costs nothing.

Weights and the VGM

VGM is the verified gross mass, the tare plus the cargo, and under SOLAS it has to be declared before the box is loaded.

1. Set **VGM Method** to **Method 1: Weighed** or **Method 2: Calculated**.
2. On a calculated VGM, type the name of the person responsible into **VGM Certified By**.

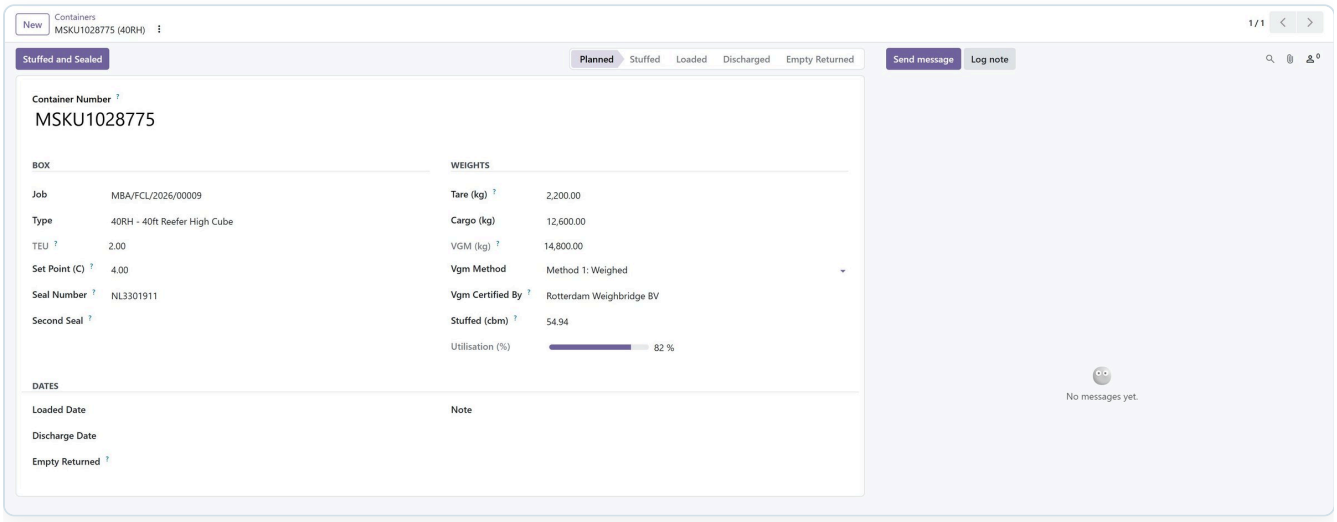


Figure 27. A reefer with its set point, its seal and a verified gross mass of just under fifteen tonnes.

> CAREFUL
>
> Three things stop a box being marked loaded: no seal number, no verified gross mass, and a calculated VGM with nobody named against it. A box stuffed over the payload for its type is refused outright, as is a stuffed volume greater than the type will hold.

Reefers

A container whose type is a reefer asks for a **Temperature** set point, and will not be marked loaded without one. Put the set point on the moment the booking is made, not when the box is at the plug.

The container's life

State	Button	What it needs first
Planned	no button	Booked but not yet stuffed.
Stuffed	**Stuffed and Sealed**	A seal number. An unsealed box is an open claim.

State	Button	What it needs first
Loaded	**Loaded**	A VGM, and a named party if it was calculated. A reefer needs its set point.
Discharged	**Discharged**	It has to have been loaded.
Empty Returned	**Empty Returned**	It has to have been discharged. The return date is what demurrage is counted against.

> KENYA
> Record the return date the day the empty goes back to the depot. On the Mombasa corridor detention runs from discharge and the free days are short; the difference between a box returned on day six and one recorded on day fourteen is a claim nobody can defend without a date.

Routing legs

A file's routing is one line per leg, in order. The **Routing** tab on the file, or **Operations > Sailings & Flights** across every file.

Leg Type	What it covers
Pre-carriage	From the shipper's door to the load port.
Main Carriage	The sea or air leg the file is sold on.
Transhipment	Where the cargo changes vessel or aircraft on the way.
On-carriage	From the discharge port inland: rail to a depot, or a truck across a border.

1. Press **Add a line**.
2. Set the **Leg Type** and the **Mode**: sea, air, road, rail or barge.
3. Set **From** and **To**. A leg that starts and ends in the same place is refused.
4. Pick the **Carrier** and name the vehicle: the **Vessel** and **Voyage** at sea, the **Flight Number** in the air, the **Truck Reference** on the road.
5. Set the **ETD** and the **ETA**. A leg that arrives before it leaves is refused.

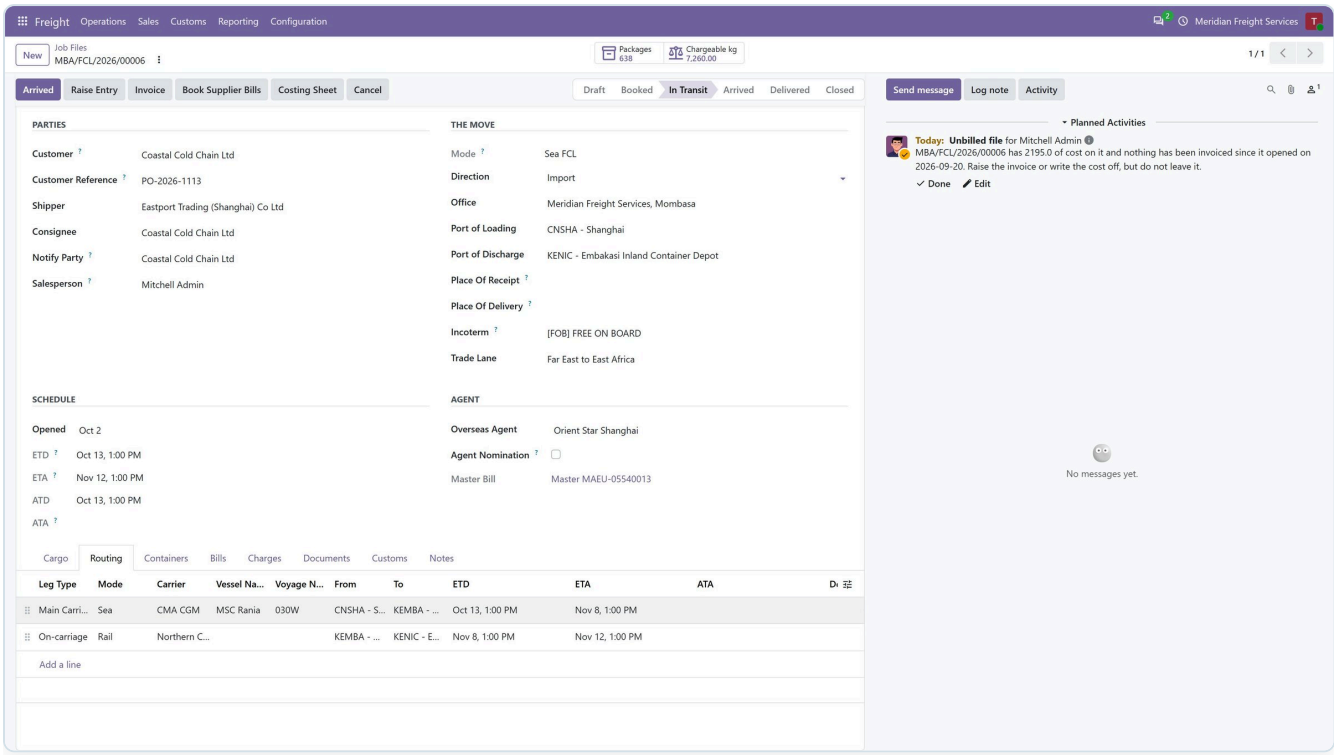


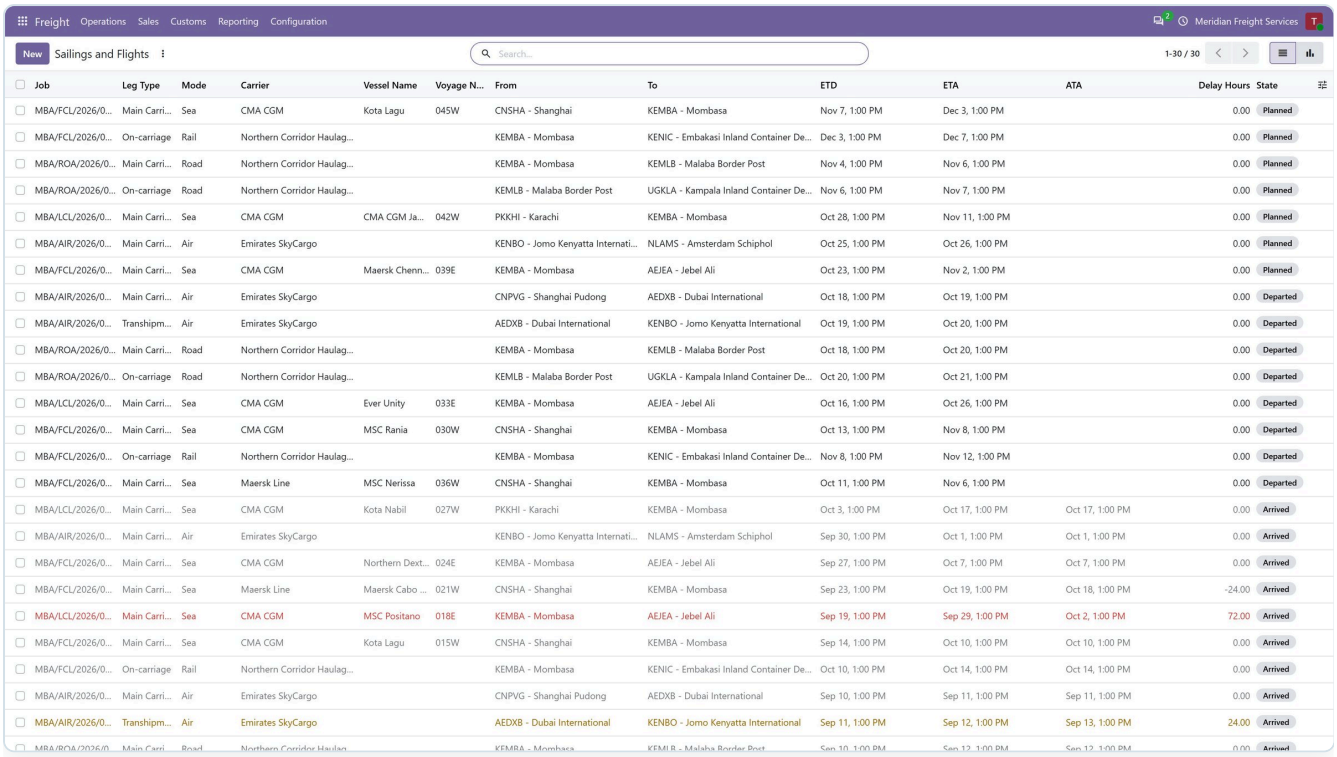
Figure 28. Two legs on an import for Nairobi: the ship to Mombasa, then the train up to the Embakasi depot.

> **TIP**
>
> Put the inland leg on even when the carrier's schedule only covers the sea leg. The file's ETA is taken from the **last** leg, so a file that stops at Mombasa tells the customer the cargo is there when it is still four days from the depot where they will collect it.

Departures and arrivals

1. On the leg, press **Departed** when it goes. Today's date and time are recorded as the actual departure.
2. Press **Arrived** when it lands, and correct the date if you are logging it a day late.

Reporting the arrival on the last leg is what gives the file its actual arrival. A sea leg that has sailed must have a vessel name on it, and a flown leg must have a flight number, because the customer will ask for both and so will the terminal.



Job	Leg Type	Mode	Carrier	Vessel Name	Voyage N...	From	To	ETD	ETA	ATA	Delay Hours	State
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	CMA CGM	Kota Lagu	045W	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Nov 7, 1:00 PM	Dec 3, 1:00 PM		0.00	Planned
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	On-carriage	Rail	Northern Corridor Haulag...			KEMBA - Mombasa	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container De...	Dec 3, 1:00 PM	Dec 7, 1:00 PM		0.00	Planned
MBA/ROA/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Road	Northern Corridor Haulag...			KEMBA - Mombasa	KEMLB - Malaba Border Post	Nov 4, 1:00 PM	Nov 6, 1:00 PM		0.00	Planned
MBA/ROA/2026/0...	On-carriage	Road	Northern Corridor Haulag...			KEMLB - Malaba Border Post	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container De...	Nov 6, 1:00 PM	Nov 7, 1:00 PM		0.00	Planned
MBA/LCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	CMA CGM	CMA CGM Ja...	042W	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 28, 1:00 PM	Nov 11, 1:00 PM		0.00	Planned
MBA/AIR/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Air	Emirates SkyCargo			KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta Internati...	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Oct 25, 1:00 PM	Oct 26, 1:00 PM		0.00	Planned
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	CMA CGM	Maersk Chenn...	039E	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Oct 23, 1:00 PM	Nov 2, 1:00 PM		0.00	Planned
MBA/AIR/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Air	Emirates SkyCargo			CNPVG - Shanghai Pudong	AEDXB - Dubai International	Oct 18, 1:00 PM	Oct 19, 1:00 PM		0.00	Departed
MBA/AIR/2026/0...	Transhipm...	Air	Emirates SkyCargo			AEDXB - Dubai International	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	Oct 19, 1:00 PM	Oct 20, 1:00 PM		0.00	Departed
MBA/ROA/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Road	Northern Corridor Haulag...			KEMBA - Mombasa	KEMLB - Malaba Border Post	Oct 18, 1:00 PM	Oct 20, 1:00 PM		0.00	Departed
MBA/ROA/2026/0...	On-carriage	Road	Northern Corridor Haulag...			KEMLB - Malaba Border Post	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container De...	Oct 20, 1:00 PM	Oct 21, 1:00 PM		0.00	Departed
MBA/LCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	CMA CGM	Ever Unity	033E	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Oct 16, 1:00 PM	Oct 26, 1:00 PM		0.00	Departed
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	CMA CGM	MSC Rania	030W	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 13, 1:00 PM	Nov 8, 1:00 PM		0.00	Departed
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	On-carriage	Rail	Northern Corridor Haulag...			KEMBA - Mombasa	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container De...	Nov 8, 1:00 PM	Nov 12, 1:00 PM		0.00	Departed
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	Maersk Line	MSC Nerissa	036W	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 11, 1:00 PM	Nov 6, 1:00 PM		0.00	Departed
MBA/LCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	CMA CGM	Kota Nabil	027W	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 3, 1:00 PM	Oct 17, 1:00 PM	Oct 17, 1:00 PM	0.00	Arrived
MBA/AIR/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Air	Emirates SkyCargo			KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta Internati...	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Sep 30, 1:00 PM	Oct 1, 1:00 PM	Oct 1, 1:00 PM	0.00	Arrived
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	CMA CGM	Northern Dext...	024E	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Sep 27, 1:00 PM	Oct 7, 1:00 PM	Oct 7, 1:00 PM	0.00	Arrived
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	Maersk Line	Maersk Cabo ...	021W	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Sep 23, 1:00 PM	Oct 19, 1:00 PM	Oct 18, 1:00 PM	-24.00	Arrived
MBA/LCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	CMA CGM	MSC Positano	018E	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Sep 19, 1:00 PM	Sep 29, 1:00 PM	Oct 2, 1:00 PM	72.00	Arrived
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Sea	CMA CGM	Kota Lagu	015W	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Sep 14, 1:00 PM	Oct 10, 1:00 PM	Oct 10, 1:00 PM	0.00	Arrived
MBA/FCL/2026/0...	On-carriage	Rail	Northern Corridor Haulag...			KEMBA - Mombasa	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container De...	Oct 10, 1:00 PM	Oct 14, 1:00 PM	Oct 14, 1:00 PM	0.00	Arrived
MBA/AIR/2026/0...	Main Carri...	Air	Emirates SkyCargo			CNPVG - Shanghai Pudong	AEDXB - Dubai International	Sep 10, 1:00 PM	Sep 11, 1:00 PM	Sep 11, 1:00 PM	0.00	Arrived
MBA/AIR/2026/0...	Transhipm...	Air	Emirates SkyCargo			AEDXB - Dubai International	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	Sep 11, 1:00 PM	Sep 12, 1:00 PM	Sep 13, 1:00 PM	24.00	Arrived

Figure 29. Every leg on every file, with its vessel or flight and how many hours late it ran.

Delay

Delay Days on the file is the actual arrival against the estimate. Positive is late. It is the number the customer asks about and the number the carrier review in chapter 10 is built on.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> Delay is only worth anything if the ETA was the real one. If the carrier moves the schedule, change the leg's ETA before the vessel arrives, not after, or the report measures the accuracy of your typing rather than the carrier's service.

CHAPTER 8

Charges, invoices and supplier bills

Every charge has a cost side and a sell side on the same line, so the profit on a file is not something anybody works out at month end. The invoice to the customer and the bill from the carrier are both raised from those lines.

In this chapter

- A charge line
- Where the quantity comes from
- Currencies
- Adding charges
- Invoicing the customer
- Booking the supplier bills
- What is locked once posted
- The costing sheet
- All charges

A charge line

On the file's **Charges** tab, each line carries what the charge costs you and what you sell it for, and therefore the profit on it.

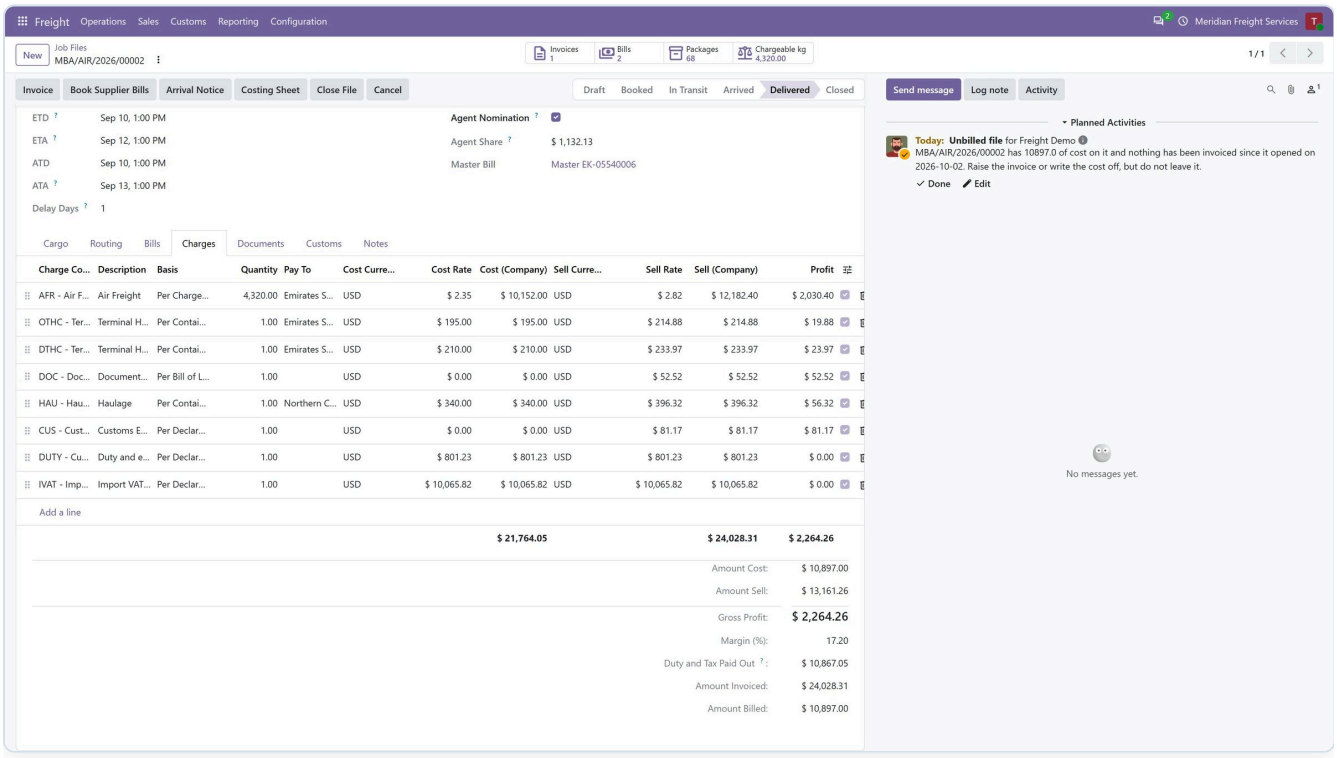


Figure 30. The charges on an air import. The duty and import VAT at the bottom carry the same figure on both sides and show no profit, so of the 24,028 dollars invoiced on this file, 10,867 is the importer's money passing through and 2,264 is what the file actually earned.

Field	What it is
Charge Code	The rate card entry. It brings the description, the category, the basis, the product and the tax.
Basis	What the quantity is counted in. Eight of them, below.
Quantity	Taken off the file by the basis. You should rarely be typing it.
Cost Rate	What you pay, per unit of the basis.
Pay To	The supplier. A cost with nobody to pay is an accrual, not a bill.
Sell Rate	What you charge, per unit of the basis.
Bill To	Who it is invoiced to, when that is not the file's customer.
Duty and Tax	Ticked on a disbursement. Recharged at cost and kept out of the profit.

Where the quantity comes from

The basis on the charge code decides what the quantity is counted in, and the file supplies the figure.

Basis	Quantity
Per Shipment	One.
Per Container	Containers on the file.
Per TEU	The TEU total.
Per Chargeable Kilo	The chargeable weight.
Per Gross Kilo	The gross weight.
Per Cubic Metre	The volume.
Per Bill of Lading	Live bills on the file.
Per Declaration	Customs entries on the file.

If the cargo changes after the charges went on, press **Refresh Charge Quantities** on the file. It redoes the quantity on every charge that has not yet been invoiced or billed, and leaves the rest alone.

> WHY IT MATTERS
> Nobody retypes a tonnage onto a rate line, which means the invoice cannot disagree with the file about how heavy the shipment was. The single most common invoicing error in forwarding is a chargeable weight that was right on the file and wrong on the invoice.

Currencies

The cost side and the sell side each carry their own currency. Buy ocean freight in dollars and sell the local charges in shillings on the same line if that is how the business works; the file converts both into the company currency for the profit figures.

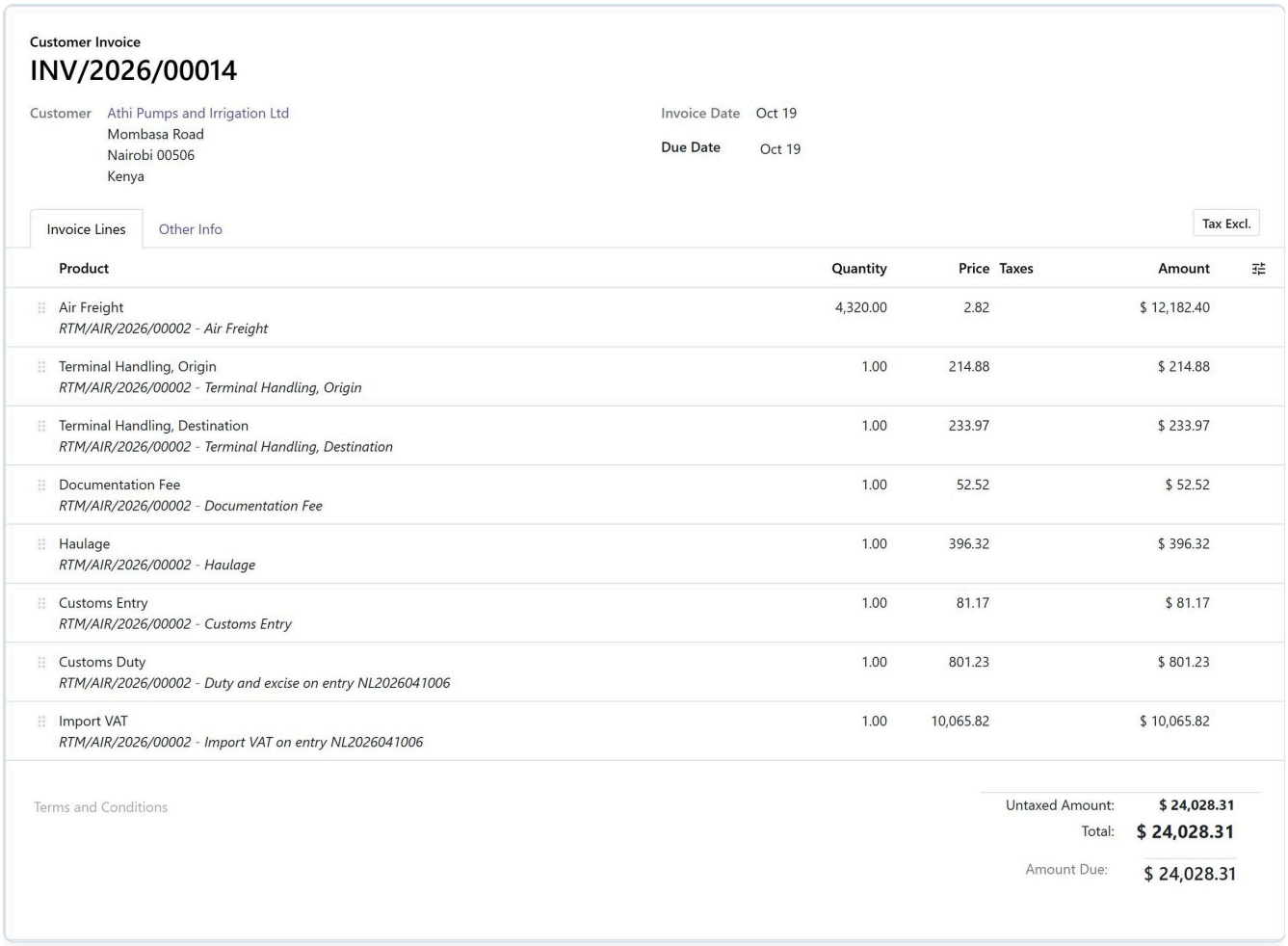
Adding charges

1. On the **Charges** tab press **Add a line**.
2. Pick the **Charge Code**. The description, basis and standard rates come across.
3. Check the **Quantity** against the file.
4. Type the **Cost Rate** and set **Pay To** if there is a supplier bill coming.
5. Type the **Sell Rate**, and set **Bill To** if this line goes to somebody other than the customer.
6. Press **Save**.

> **TIP**
>
> Put the cost on as soon as you know it, even before the supplier's invoice arrives. A file with the cost on and nothing invoiced appears in **Unbilled Files** and gets chased. A file with neither appears nowhere and is forgotten.

Invoicing the customer

1. Open the file and press **Invoice**.
2. Every sell line that has not been invoiced is put onto a draft invoice. Lines are grouped by who they are billed to and by currency, so one file can raise two invoices if part of it goes to a different party.
3. Check the draft and post it in the usual Odoo way.



Customer Invoice

INV/2026/00014

Customer Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd
Mombasa Road
Nairobi 00506
Kenya

Invoice Date Oct 19

Due Date Oct 19

Invoice Lines | Other Info | Tax Excl.

Product	Quantity	Price	Taxes	Amount
Air Freight *RTM/AIR/2026/00002 - Air Freight*	4,320.00	2.82		$ 12,182.40
Terminal Handling, Origin *RTM/AIR/2026/00002 - Terminal Handling, Origin*	1.00	214.88		$ 214.88
Terminal Handling, Destination *RTM/AIR/2026/00002 - Terminal Handling, Destination*	1.00	233.97		$ 233.97
Documentation Fee *RTM/AIR/2026/00002 - Documentation Fee*	1.00	52.52		$ 52.52
Haulage *RTM/AIR/2026/00002 - Haulage*	1.00	396.32		$ 396.32
Customs Entry *RTM/AIR/2026/00002 - Customs Entry*	1.00	81.17		$ 81.17
Customs Duty *RTM/AIR/2026/00002 - Duty and excise on entry NL2026041006*	1.00	801.23		$ 801.23
Import VAT *RTM/AIR/2026/00002 - Import VAT on entry NL2026041006*	1.00	10,065.82		$ 10,065.82

Terms and Conditions

Untaxed Amount: $ 24,028.31
Total: $ 24,028.31
Amount Due: $ 24,028.31

Figure 31. The invoice raised off the file. The file number is on it as the source, and the customer's own reference is in the reference field so it gets paid.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> The button refuses on a draft or a cancelled file, and refuses again if every sell line has already been invoiced. If you need to invoice more, put the charge on the file first; do not add lines straight onto the invoice, or the file and the invoice stop agreeing.

Booking the supplier bills

1. Press **Book Supplier Bills**.
2. Every cost line with a named supplier and no bill yet is put onto a draft bill, grouped by supplier and currency.
3. Check each against the supplier's invoice and post it.

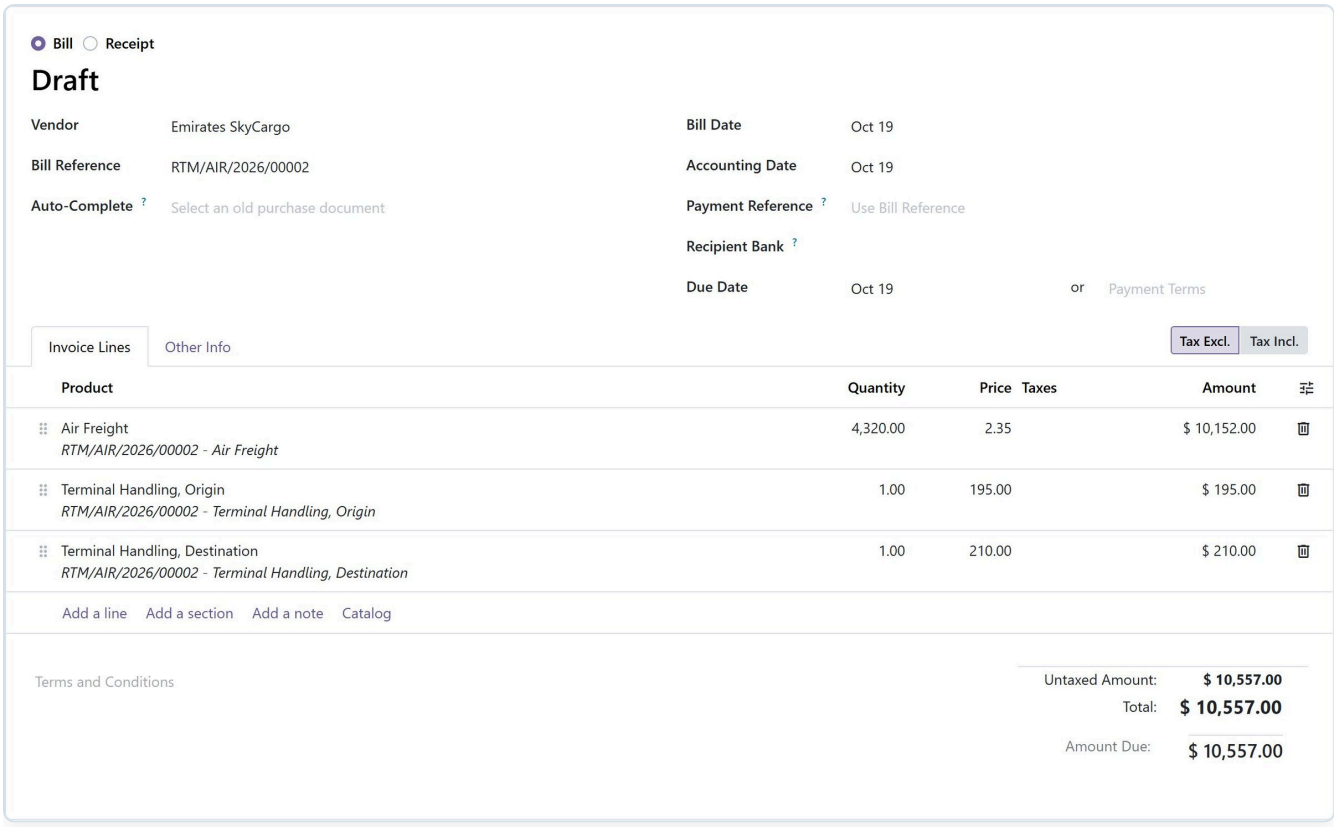


Figure 32. The supplier bill, raised from the cost side of the same charge lines.

A cost with no supplier named is left alone on purpose: it is an accrual or a deferment, not a bill.

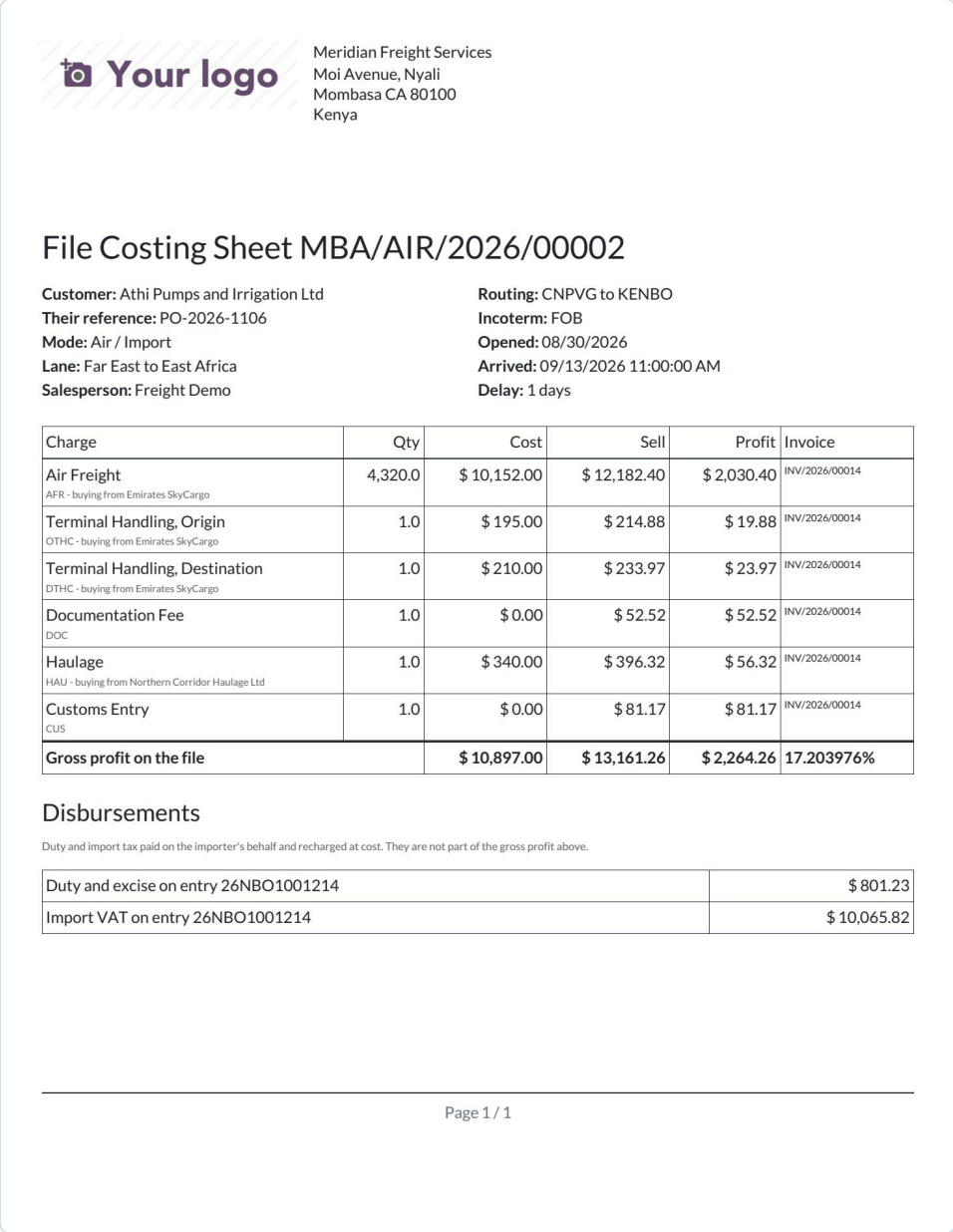
What is locked once posted

Once a charge sits behind a posted invoice, its sell rate, quantity, tax, currency, billing party and charge code are locked. The same applies on the cost side once a supplier bill is posted. The description can still be corrected.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> Swapping the charge code on an invoiced line would move money in or out of the gross profit without the posted invoice changing by a penny. If the invoice is wrong, credit it; that way the correction is a document the customer and the auditor can both see.

The costing sheet

Costing Sheet prints the file's whole money position on one page: every charge with its cost, its sell and its margin, the totals, the disbursements kept separate, and the gross profit.



Your logo

Meridian Freight Services
Moi Avenue, Nyali
Mombasa CA 80100
Kenya

File Costing Sheet MBA/AIR/2026/00002

Customer: Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd
Their reference: PO-2026-1106
Mode: Air / Import
Lane: Far East to East Africa
Salesperson: Freight Demo

Routing: CNPVG to KENBO
Incoterm: FOB
Opened: 08/30/2026
Arrived: 09/13/2026 11:00:00 AM
Delay: 1 days

Charge	Qty	Cost	Sell	Profit	Invoice
Air Freight AFR - buying from Emirates SkyCargo	4,320.0	$ 10,152.00	$ 12,182.40	$ 2,030.40	INV/2026/00014
Terminal Handling, Origin OTHC - buying from Emirates SkyCargo	1.0	$ 195.00	$ 214.88	$ 19.88	INV/2026/00014
Terminal Handling, Destination DTHC - buying from Emirates SkyCargo	1.0	$ 210.00	$ 233.97	$ 23.97	INV/2026/00014
Documentation Fee DOC	1.0	$ 0.00	$ 52.52	$ 52.52	INV/2026/00014
Haulage HAU - buying from Northern Corridor Haulage Ltd	1.0	$ 340.00	$ 396.32	$ 56.32	INV/2026/00014
Customs Entry CUS	1.0	$ 0.00	$ 81.17	$ 81.17	INV/2026/00014
Gross profit on the file		**$ 10,897.00**	**$ 13,161.26**	**$ 2,264.26**	**17.203976%**

Disbursements

Duty and import tax paid on the importer's behalf and recharged at cost. They are not part of the gross profit above.

Duty and excise on entry 26NBO1001214	$ 801.23
Import VAT on entry 26NBO1001214	$ 10,065.82

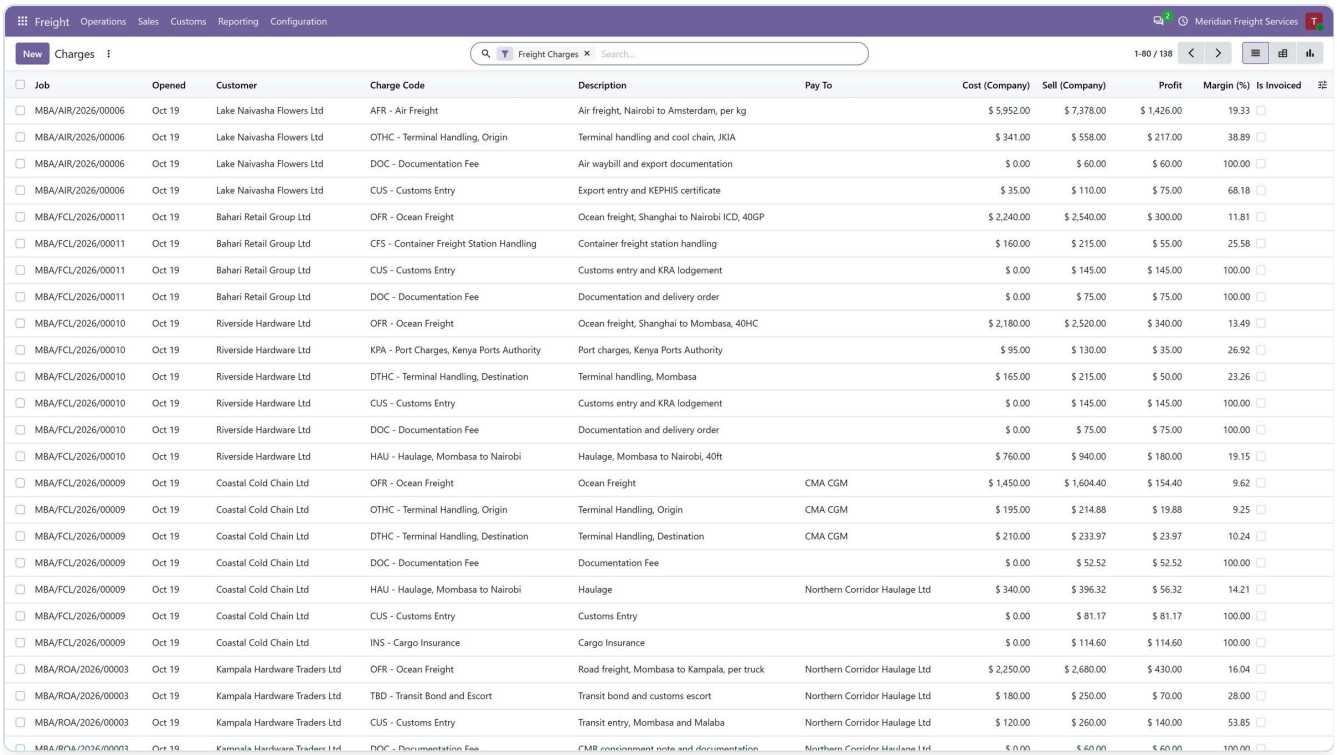
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Figure 33. The costing sheet. This is the page to have in front of you before a file is closed.

> **CAREFUL**
> The costing sheet shows cost and margin. It is an internal document. It is not the invoice and it does not go to the customer.

All charges

Reporting > All Charges is every charge line on every file in one list, with cost, sell, profit and margin, and whether it has been invoiced and billed. Group it by charge code to see what each service earns across the book; group it by supplier to see what you buy from each carrier.



Job	Opened	Customer	Charge Code	Description	Pay To	Cost (Company)	Sell (Company)	Profit	Margin (%)	Is Invoiced
MBA/AIR/2026/00006	Oct 19	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	AFR - Air Freight	Air freight, Nairobi to Amsterdam, per kg		$ 5,952.00	$ 7,378.00	$ 1,426.00	19.33	
MBA/AIR/2026/00006	Oct 19	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	OTHC - Terminal Handling, Origin	Terminal handling and cool chain, JKIA		$ 341.00	$ 558.00	$ 217.00	38.89	
MBA/AIR/2026/00006	Oct 19	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	DOC - Documentation Fee	Air waybill and export documentation		$ 0.00	$ 60.00	$ 60.00	100.00	
MBA/AIR/2026/00006	Oct 19	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	CUS - Customs Entry	Export entry and KEPHIS certificate		$ 35.00	$ 110.00	$ 75.00	68.18	
MBA/FCL/2026/00011	Oct 19	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	OFR - Ocean Freight	Ocean freight, Shanghai to Nairobi ICD, 40GP		$ 2,240.00	$ 2,540.00	$ 300.00	11.81	
MBA/FCL/2026/00011	Oct 19	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	CFS - Container Freight Station Handling	Container freight station handling		$ 160.00	$ 215.00	$ 55.00	25.58	
MBA/FCL/2026/00011	Oct 19	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	CUS - Customs Entry	Customs entry and KRA lodgement		$ 0.00	$ 145.00	$ 145.00	100.00	
MBA/FCL/2026/00011	Oct 19	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	DOC - Documentation Fee	Documentation and delivery order		$ 0.00	$ 75.00	$ 75.00	100.00	
MBA/FCL/2026/00010	Oct 19	Riverside Hardware Ltd	OFR - Ocean Freight	Ocean freight, Shanghai to Mombasa, 40HC		$ 2,180.00	$ 2,520.00	$ 340.00	13.49	
MBA/FCL/2026/00010	Oct 19	Riverside Hardware Ltd	KPA - Port Charges, Kenya Ports Authority	Port charges, Kenya Ports Authority		$ 95.00	$ 130.00	$ 35.00	26.92	
MBA/FCL/2026/00010	Oct 19	Riverside Hardware Ltd	DTHC - Terminal Handling, Destination	Terminal handling, Mombasa		$ 165.00	$ 215.00	$ 50.00	23.26	
MBA/FCL/2026/00010	Oct 19	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CUS - Customs Entry	Customs entry and KRA lodgement		$ 0.00	$ 145.00	$ 145.00	100.00	
MBA/FCL/2026/00010	Oct 19	Riverside Hardware Ltd	DOC - Documentation Fee	Documentation and delivery order		$ 0.00	$ 75.00	$ 75.00	100.00	
MBA/FCL/2026/00010	Oct 19	Riverside Hardware Ltd	HAU - Haulage, Mombasa to Nairobi	Haulage, Mombasa to Nairobi, 40ft		$ 760.00	$ 940.00	$ 180.00	19.15	
MBA/FCL/2026/00009	Oct 19	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	OFR - Ocean Freight	Ocean Freight	CMA CGM	$ 1,450.00	$ 1,604.40	$ 154.40	9.62	
MBA/FCL/2026/00009	Oct 19	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	OTHC - Terminal Handling, Origin	Terminal Handling, Origin	CMA CGM	$ 195.00	$ 214.88	$ 19.88	9.25	
MBA/FCL/2026/00009	Oct 19	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	DTHC - Terminal Handling, Destination	Terminal Handling, Destination	CMA CGM	$ 210.00	$ 233.97	$ 23.97	10.24	
MBA/FCL/2026/00009	Oct 19	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	DOC - Documentation Fee	Documentation Fee		$ 0.00	$ 52.52	$ 52.52	100.00	
MBA/FCL/2026/00009	Oct 19	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	HAU - Haulage, Mombasa to Nairobi	Haulage	Northern Corridor Haulage Ltd	$ 340.00	$ 396.32	$ 56.32	14.21	
MBA/FCL/2026/00009	Oct 19	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	CUS - Customs Entry	Customs Entry		$ 0.00	$ 81.17	$ 81.17	100.00	
MBA/FCL/2026/00009	Oct 19	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	INS - Cargo Insurance	Cargo Insurance		$ 0.00	$ 114.60	$ 114.60	100.00	
MBA/ROA/2026/00003	Oct 19	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	OFR - Ocean Freight	Road freight, Mombasa to Kampala, per truck	Northern Corridor Haulage Ltd	$ 2,250.00	$ 2,680.00	$ 430.00	16.04	
MBA/ROA/2026/00003	Oct 19	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	TBD - Transit Bond and Escort	Transit bond and customs escort	Northern Corridor Haulage Ltd	$ 180.00	$ 250.00	$ 70.00	28.00	
MBA/ROA/2026/00003	Oct 19	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	CUS - Customs Entry	Transit entry, Mombasa and Malaba	Northern Corridor Haulage Ltd	$ 120.00	$ 260.00	$ 140.00	53.85	
MBA/ROA/2026/00003	Oct 19	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	DOC - Documentation Fee	CMR consignment note and documentation	Northern Corridor Haulage Ltd	$ 0.00	$ 60.00	$ 60.00	100.00	

Figure 34. Every charge line in the business, with both sides of each.

CHAPTER 9

Customs

One entry per file. The tariff lines are built from the cargo, the freight you actually charged is brought into the value and spread across them, and the duty you lay out is recharged pound for pound without ever touching the profit.

In this chapter

- Raising an entry
- The regimes
- Building the tariff lines
- What is brought into the value
- How the duty is worked out
- Restricted goods
- Lodging, queries and clearing
- Disbursing the duty
- Transit
- The worksheet
- Duty by commodity

Raising an entry

1. Open the file and press **Raise Entry**.
2. The entry is created with the regime set from the direction, the declarant set to the customer and the entry port set to the discharge point on an import or the loading point on an export. The tariff lines are built straight away.
3. Type the **Entry Number** once customs gives you one.



Figure 35. The declarations. Each one shows its file, its regime, the value and what is payable on it.

CAREFUL

Two things stop an entry being raised. A branch set to **Forwarding Only** cannot lodge one, and the refusal names the office. And cargo with no tariff code on it has nothing to declare, so put the HS codes on the cargo lines first.

The regimes

Regime	When
Import for Home Use	Goods entering the country and staying. Duty and VAT are paid.
Permanent Export	Goods leaving.

Regime	When
Transit	Goods crossing on the way somewhere else, secured by a bond.
Customs Warehousing	Goods entering a bonded warehouse, duty deferred.
Temporary Admission	Goods in for a while and going out again.
Inward Processing	Goods in to be worked on and re-exported.
Re-export	Goods going back out.

Building the tariff lines

Build From Cargo takes the cargo off the file and makes one tariff line per commodity, bringing across the description, the pieces, the weights and the value, and the duty, excise and VAT rates from the HS code. It then brings in the freight and insurance and apportions them.

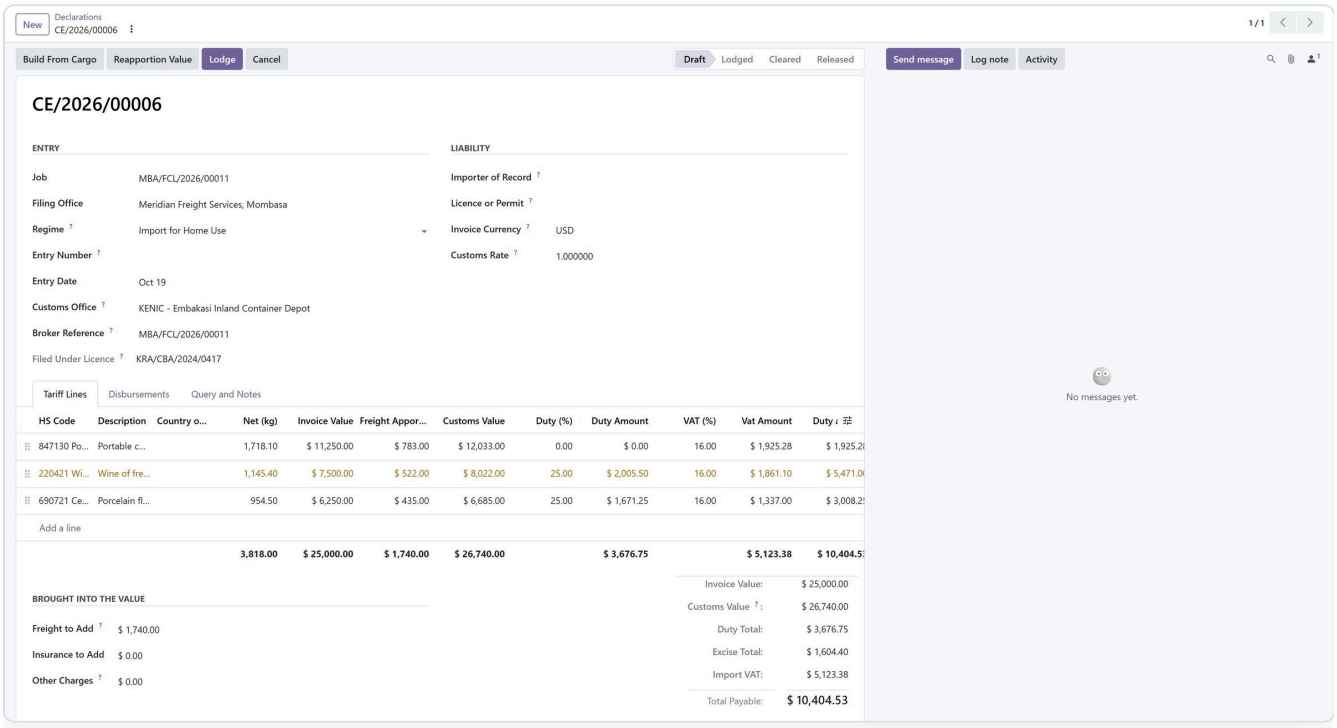


Figure 36. Three commodities on one entry. The computers clear free of duty, the tiles at twenty five percent, and the wine carries excise on top of the duty.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> The button only works while the entry is in draft. Once it has been lodged, an entry is amended through a correction with customs, not by rebuilding it here.

What is brought into the value

Customs charges duty on the landed value, not the invoice value, so three figures are added to the goods.

Field	Where it comes from
Freight to Add	The freight, origin and destination charges actually on the file. On a CIF entry it is already in the invoice; on an FOB entry it is not.
Insurance to Add	The insurance charged on the file.
Other Charges	Handling, inspection or agency fees that customs counts as part of the value.

Those three are spread across the tariff lines **by value**, not evenly, because a pallet of pumps and a pallet of packing foam do not carry the same duty. Correct any of the three and press **Reapportion Value** to redo the split.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> Apportioning by value is what the valuation rules require, and it is also the part people get wrong by hand. On the entry in the screenshot, 1,740 dollars of freight is split 783, 522 and 435 across the three commodities in proportion to what each is worth. Splitting it in three equal parts would have moved duty from the zero rated line onto the twenty five percent line and cost the importer money.

How the duty is worked out

Per line, in this order.

Figure	Worked out as
Customs Value	Invoice value + apportioned freight + apportioned insurance
Duty	Customs value × duty rate
Excise	Customs value × excise rate
Import VAT	(Customs value + duty + excise) × VAT rate
Line Total	Duty + excise + VAT

VAT sits on top of the duty and the excise, not beside them. The rates come from the HS code; where a code has no VAT rate of its own, the standard rate in the settings is used so a new commodity does not quietly clear at zero.

> KENYA
>
> The EAC Common External Tariff bands are nought, ten and twenty five percent, import VAT is sixteen, and fertiliser, bulk tea and most medicaments are exempt. Set those rates on the tariff codes once and every entry built from the cargo is right. The Import Declaration Fee and the Railway Development Levy are charges rather than tariff lines: put them on the file as duty and tax charge codes, as in chapter 3.

Restricted goods

A tariff code marked restricted makes its line restricted on the entry. An entry carrying a restricted line will not clear without something in **Licence or Permit**, and the refusal lists the codes that need one.

> **WHY IT MATTERS**
>
> Customs will not release restricted goods without the permit and neither should you. Clearing an entry in the system that has not really been cleared is how a release gets authorised against cargo that is still held.

Lodging, queries and clearing

1. Check the lines and press **Lodge**. The entry moves to **Lodged** and the time is recorded.
2. If customs comes back with a question, press **Customs Queried** and write what they asked in **Query Note**. A queried entry can be corrected and lodged again.
3. When it clears, put the entry number on if you have not already and press **Cleared**.
4. When the goods are released, press **Released**.

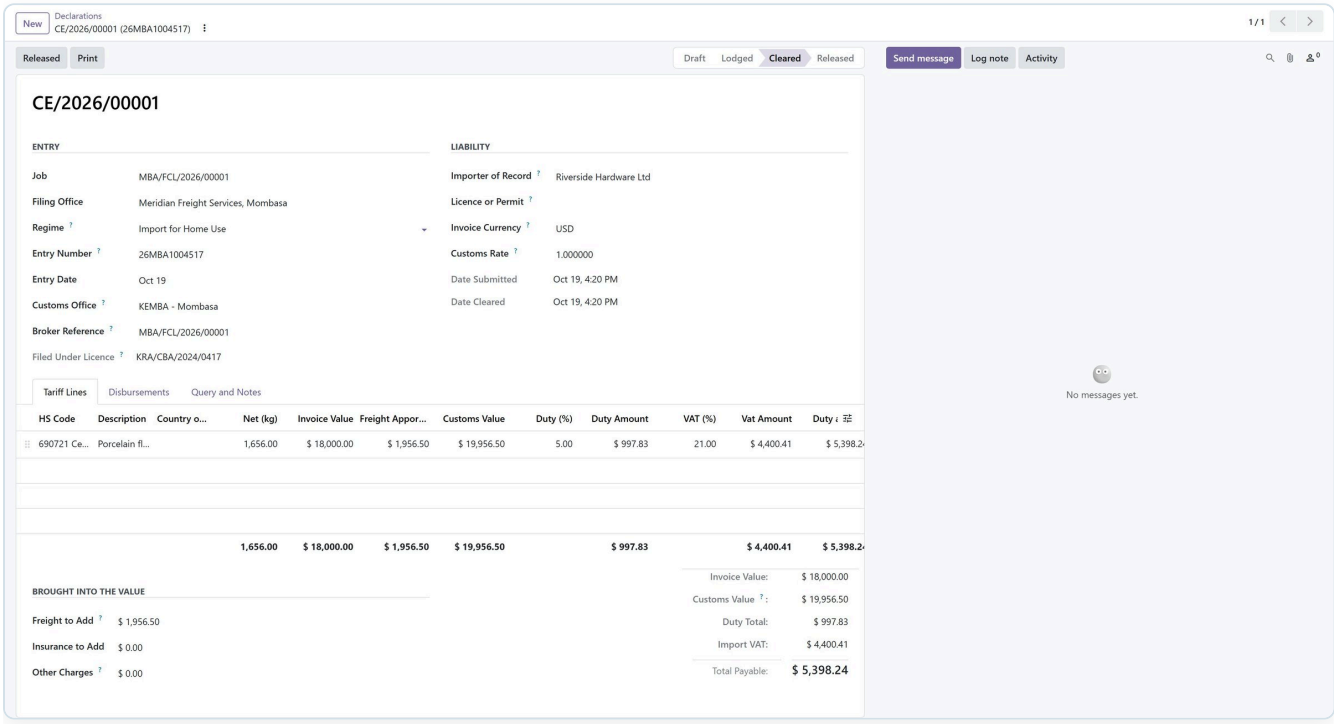


Figure 37. A cleared entry with its KRA number and the duty and VAT that were paid on it.

Clearing the last open entry on a file moves the file itself to **Customs Cleared** and posts a note with the entry number and the total paid. The broker does not need write access to the operations file for that to happen.

Disbursing the duty

Duty and import VAT are the importer's money, laid out by you. **Disburse Duty to the File** puts them onto the file as two charge lines, flagged as duty and tax, with the same figure on the cost side and the sell side.

1. Open the cleared entry.
2. Press **Disburse Duty to the File**.
3. Two charges appear on the file: the duty and excise, and the import VAT, each quoting the entry number.

> **WHY IT MATTERS**
>
> Because the two lines carry the same cost and sell, they produce no profit, and because they are flagged they stay out of the margin on the file entirely. A file that moved forty thousand dollars of duty still shows the eight hundred dollars of forwarding profit it actually earned. Keeping those two apart is the single most important thing this module does with a broker's money.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> The button refuses on an entry that has not cleared, and refuses a second time if the duty is already on the file. An entry cannot be cancelled once its duty has been disbursed; take the charges off the file first.

Transit

A transit entry is raised the same way, with **Regime** set to **Transit**. The duty and VAT are still worked out, because that is the figure the bond has to cover, but the goods are entered for home use at the far end and nothing is paid here.

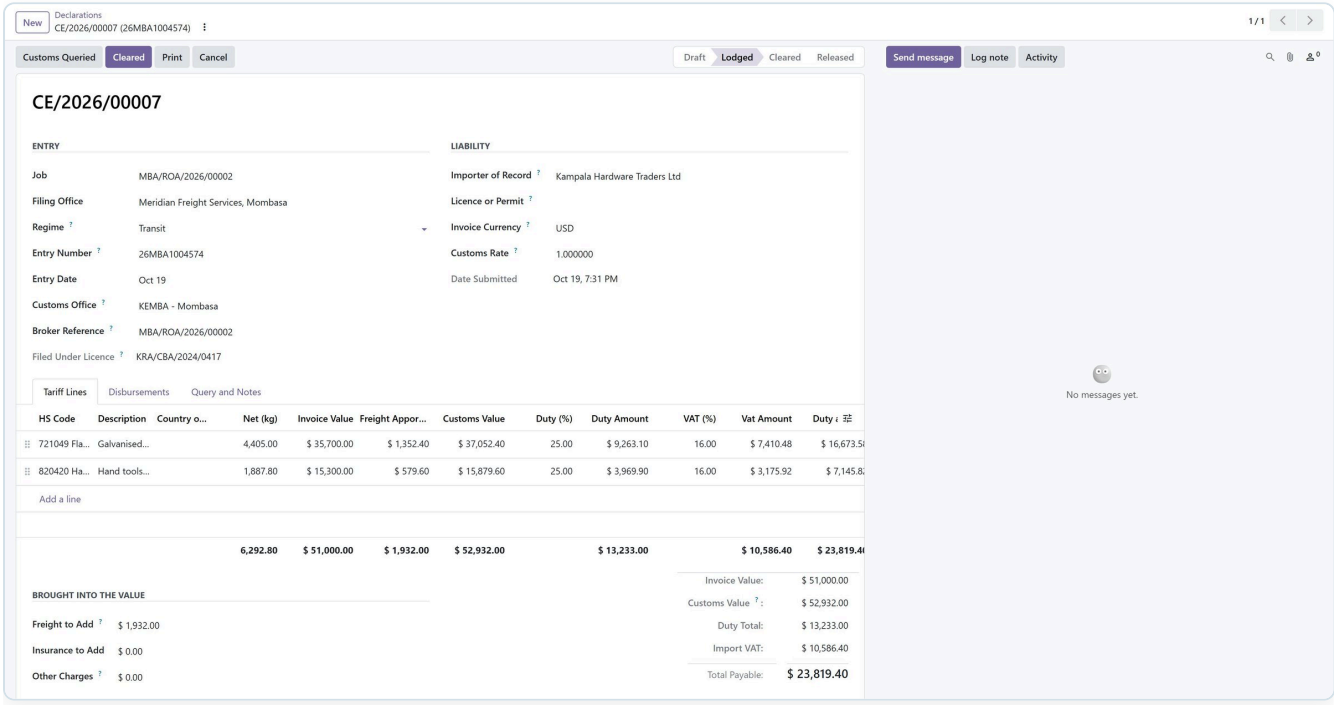
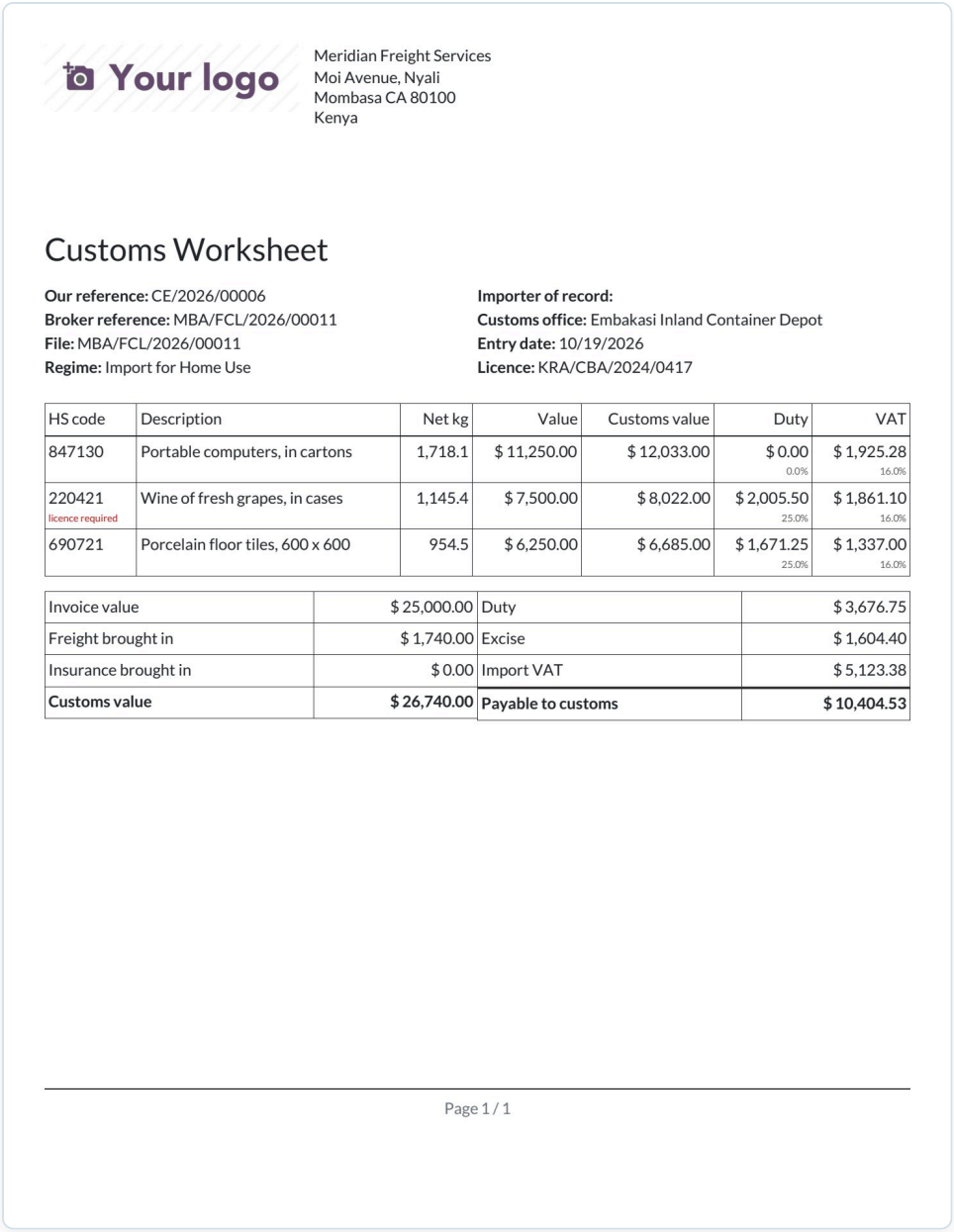


Figure 38. A transit entry for cargo moving to Kampala under bond.

> **KENYA**
>
> Do not disburse the duty on a transit entry onto the file. The amount shown is the security under the bond, not a payment. Write that on the entry's note so the next person to open it does not recharge the importer for money that never left the business.

The worksheet

Print produces the customs worksheet: the entry and its number, the office and the licence it is filed under, every tariff line with its value and its duty, and the totals.



Your logo

Meridian Freight Services
Moi Avenue, Nyali
Mombasa CA 80100
Kenya

Customs Worksheet

Our reference: CE/2026/00006
Broker reference: MBA/FCL/2026/00011
File: MBA/FCL/2026/00011
Regime: Import for Home Use

Importer of record:
Customs office: Embakasi Inland Container Depot
Entry date: 10/19/2026
Licence: KRA/CBA/2024/0417

HS code	Description	Net kg	Value	Customs value	Duty	VAT
847130	Portable computers, in cartons	1,718.1	$ 11,250.00	$ 12,033.00	$ 0.00 0.0%	$ 1,925.28 16.0%
220421 licence required	Wine of fresh grapes, in cases	1,145.4	$ 7,500.00	$ 8,022.00	$ 2,005.50 25.0%	$ 1,861.10 16.0%
690721	Porcelain floor tiles, 600 x 600	954.5	$ 6,250.00	$ 6,685.00	$ 1,671.25 25.0%	$ 1,337.00 16.0%

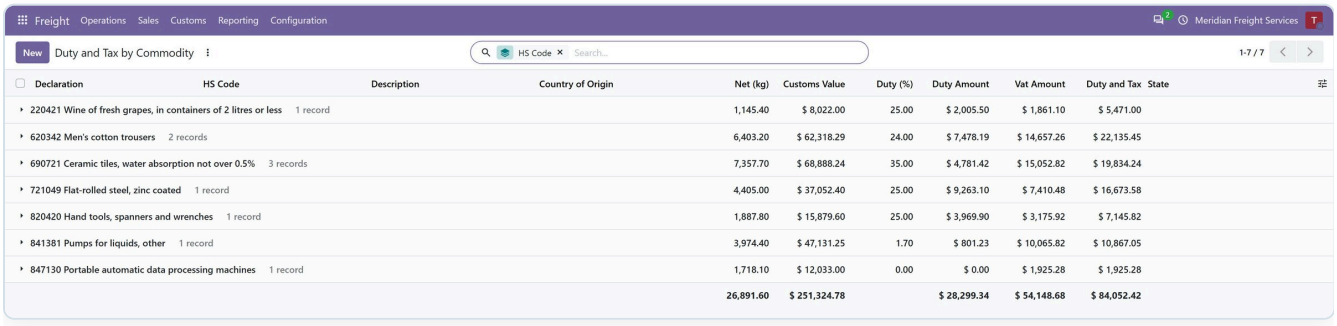
Invoice value	$ 25,000.00	Duty	$ 3,676.75
Freight brought in	$ 1,740.00	Excise	$ 1,604.40
Insurance brought in	$ 0.00	Import VAT	$ 5,123.38
Customs value	**$ 26,740.00**	**Payable to customs**	**$ 10,404.53**

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Figure 39. The worksheet. This is the page that goes in the file and gets checked against what customs assessed.

Duty by commodity

Customs > Duty and Tax by Commodity is every tariff line across every entry. Group it by HS code to see what each commodity has cost in duty over a year; group it by declarant to see which importer carries the tax.



Freight Operations Sales Customs Reporting Configuration — Meridian Freight Services

New | Duty and Tax by Commodity | HS Code | Search... | 1-7 / 7

Declaration	HS Code	Description	Country of Origin	Net (kg)	Customs Value	Duty (%)	Duty Amount	Vat Amount	Duty and Tax	State
220421 Wine of fresh grapes, in containers of 2 litres or less	1 record			1,145.40	$ 8,022.00	25.00	$ 2,005.50	$ 1,861.10	$ 5,471.00	
620342 Men's cotton trousers	2 records			6,403.20	$ 62,318.29	24.00	$ 7,478.19	$ 14,657.26	$ 22,135.45	
690721 Ceramic tiles, water absorption not over 0.5%	3 records			7,357.70	$ 68,888.24	35.00	$ 4,781.42	$ 15,052.82	$ 19,834.24	
721049 Flat-rolled steel, zinc coated	1 record			4,405.00	$ 37,052.40	25.00	$ 9,263.10	$ 7,410.48	$ 16,673.58	
820420 Hand tools, spanners and wrenches	1 record			1,887.80	$ 15,879.60	25.00	$ 3,969.90	$ 3,175.92	$ 7,145.82	
841381 Pumps for liquids, other	1 record			3,974.40	$ 47,131.25	1.70	$ 801.23	$ 10,065.82	$ 10,867.05	
847130 Portable automatic data processing machines	1 record			1,718.10	$ 12,033.00	0.00	$ 0.00	$ 1,925.28	$ 1,925.28	
				26,891.60	**$ 251,324.78**		**$ 28,299.34**	**$ 54,148.68**	**$ 84,052.42**	

Figure 40. Tariff lines across all entries, with the value, the duty and the VAT on each.

CHAPTER 10

The money

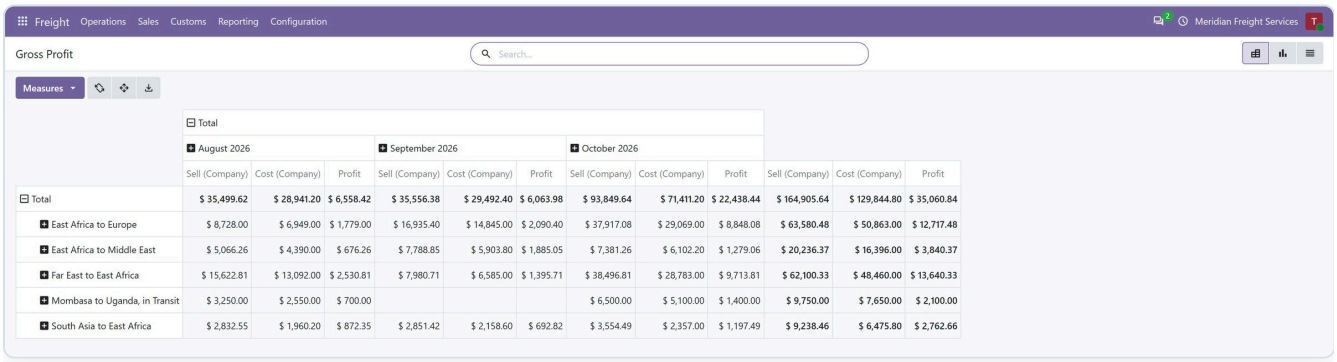
Five reports, built off the same charge lines the invoices come from. Two of them tell you how the business is doing; three of them tell you where it is quietly losing money this week.

In this chapter

- Gross profit
- By lane, by salesperson, by month
- Unbilled files
- Costs without a bill
- Arrival delays
- Under target
- The agent's share
- A monthly routine

Gross profit

Reporting > Gross Profit. A pivot of every file: what was sold, what it cost, and what is left. Rows are trade lanes and columns are months to begin with, and both can be changed to anything on the file.



	Total			August 2026			September 2026			October 2026		
	Sell (Company)	Cost (Company)	Profit	Sell (Company)	Cost (Company)	Profit	Sell (Company)	Cost (Company)	Profit	Sell (Company)	Cost (Company)	Profit
Total	$ 35,499.62	$ 28,941.20	$ 6,558.42	$ 35,556.38	$ 29,492.40	$ 6,063.98	$ 93,849.64	$ 71,411.20	$ 22,438.44	$ 164,905.64	$ 129,844.80	$ 35,060.84
East Africa to Europe	$ 8,728.00	$ 6,949.00	$ 1,779.00	$ 16,935.40	$ 14,845.00	$ 2,090.40	$ 37,917.08	$ 29,069.00	$ 8,848.08	$ 63,580.48	$ 50,863.00	$ 12,717.48
East Africa to Middle East	$ 5,066.26	$ 4,390.00	$ 676.26	$ 7,788.85	$ 5,903.80	$ 1,885.05	$ 7,381.26	$ 6,102.20	$ 1,279.06	$ 20,236.37	$ 16,396.00	$ 3,840.37
Far East to East Africa	$ 15,622.81	$ 13,092.00	$ 2,530.81	$ 7,980.71	$ 6,585.00	$ 1,395.71	$ 38,496.81	$ 28,783.00	$ 9,713.81	$ 62,100.33	$ 48,460.00	$ 13,640.33
Mombasa to Uganda, in Transit	$ 3,250.00	$ 2,550.00	$ 700.00				$ 6,500.00	$ 5,100.00	$ 1,400.00	$ 9,750.00	$ 7,650.00	$ 2,100.00
South Asia to East Africa	$ 2,832.55	$ 1,960.20	$ 872.35	$ 2,851.42	$ 2,158.60	$ 692.82	$ 3,554.49	$ 2,357.00	$ 1,197.49	$ 9,238.46	$ 6,475.80	$ 2,762.66

Figure 41. Three months by trade lane. Far East inbound is the biggest lane by revenue; East Africa to Europe makes more profit on less of it.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> These figures are not a separate set of books. They are the same charge lines the customer invoices were raised from and the same ones the supplier bills were booked against, which is why the file cannot be closed until both sides are done. A profit report whose numbers nobody can tie back to an invoice gets argued with; this one cannot be.

By lane, by salesperson, by month

1. Press the minus beside **Total** on the left to collapse the rows.
2. Press the plus and pick what to group by: **Trade Lane**, **Salesperson**, **Customer**, **Mode**, **Office** or **Overseas Agent**.

3. Do the same along the top for the columns.
4. **Measures** switches the figures between sell, cost and profit.
5. The download button puts the whole pivot into a spreadsheet, laid out as you left it.

> **TIP**
> Lane by salesperson is the one worth looking at every month. It shows who is winning the thin business, which is a very different conversation from who is winning the most business.

Unbilled files

Reporting > Unbilled Files. Files carrying cost where nothing has been invoiced.

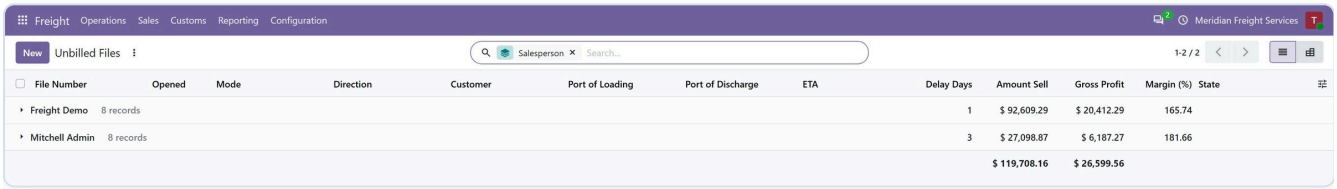


Figure 42. Files with cost on them and no invoice out.

After the number of days set in **Chase Unbilled Files After**, the salesperson on the file gets an activity about it. Fourteen days is the usual setting.

> **WHY IT MATTERS**
> This is where a forwarder's money quietly disappears. Nobody forgets to pay the shipping line, because the shipping line asks. The invoice that was never raised is not missed by anyone until the file is six months old and the customer has forgotten the shipment.

Costs without a bill

Reporting > Costs Without a Bill. The other side: charge lines with a cost and a named supplier, where no supplier bill has been booked.

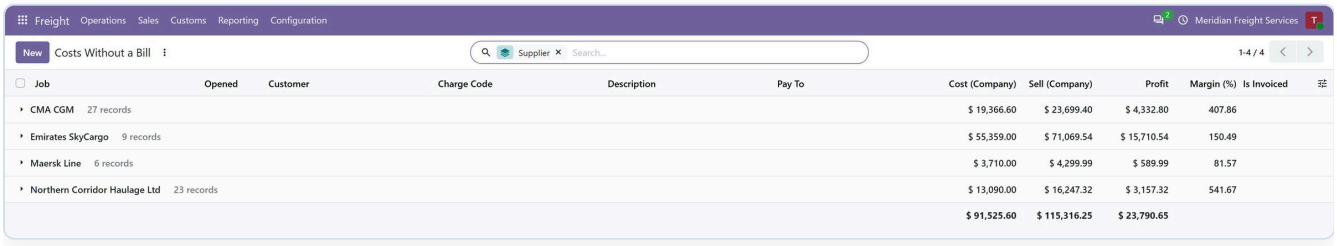


Figure 43. Costs with a supplier named and no bill against them yet.

These are the accruals. Either the invoice has not arrived, in which case the file's profit is right and the bill is coming, or it arrived and was not booked, in which case the profit on that file is overstated by exactly that amount.

Arrival delays

Reporting > Arrival Delays. Average delay in days, by trade lane, and by carrier if you group it that way.

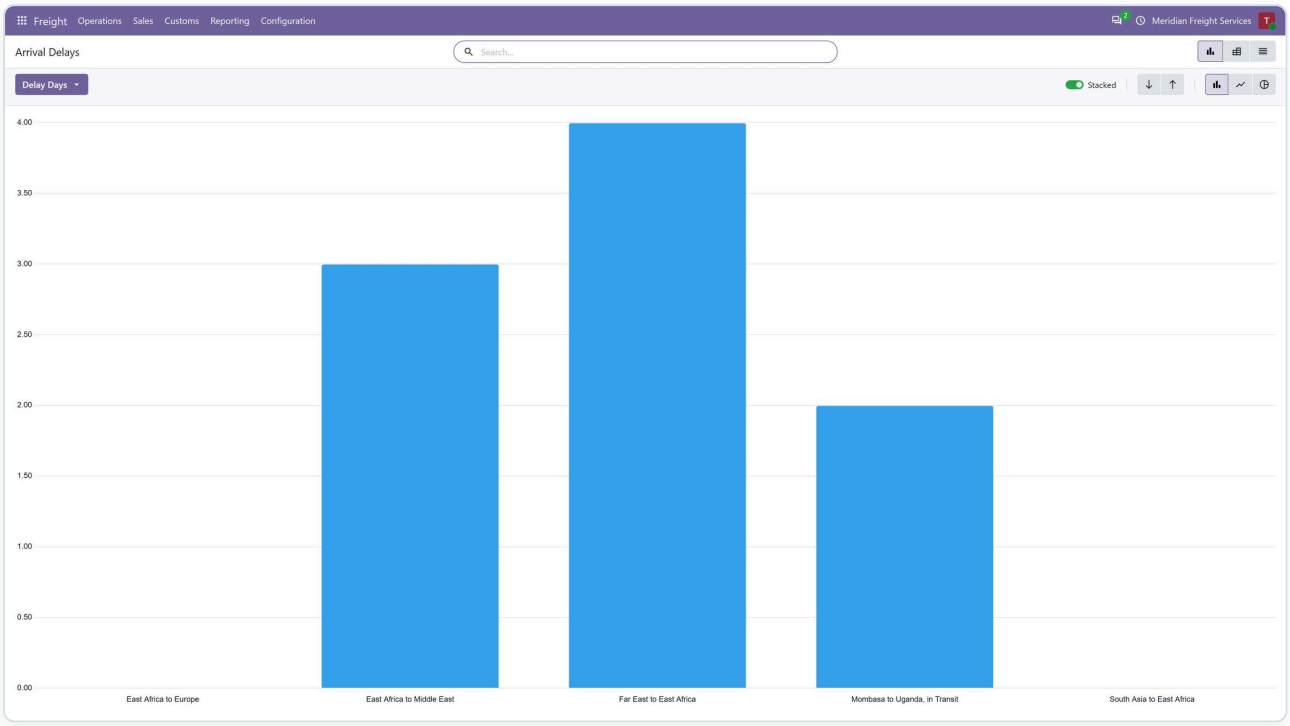
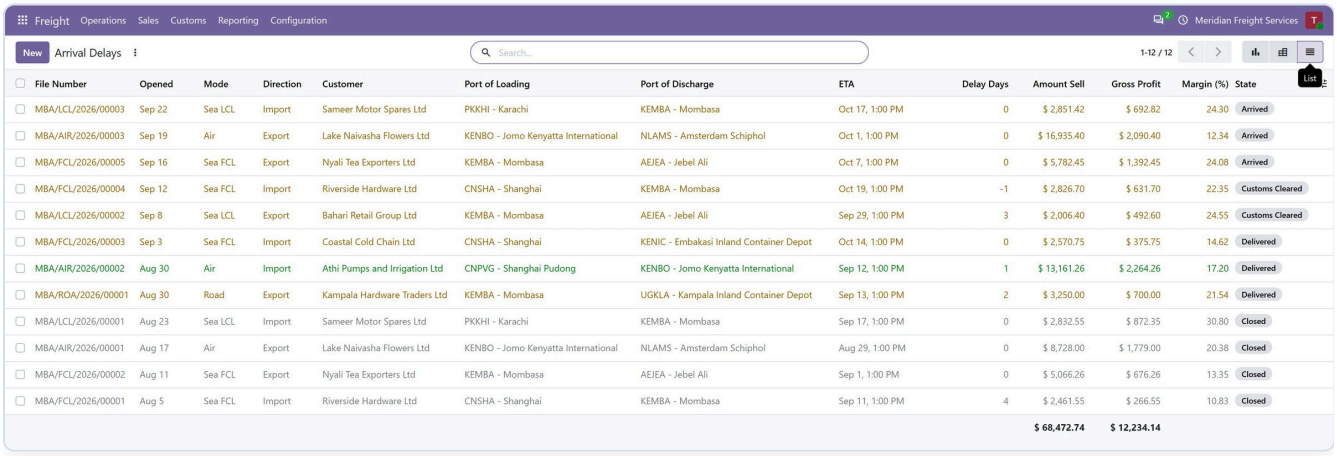


Figure 44. Average days late by lane.



File Number	Opened	Mode	Direction	Customer	Port of Loading	Port of Discharge	ETA	Delay Days	Amount Sell	Gross Profit	Margin (%)	State
MBA/LCL/2026/00003	Sep 22	Sea LCL	Import	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 17, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,851.42	$ 692.82	24.30	Arrived
MBA/AIR/2026/00003	Sep 19	Air	Export	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Oct 1, 1:00 PM	0	$ 16,935.40	$ 2,090.40	12.34	Arrived
MBA/FCL/2026/00005	Sep 16	Sea FCL	Export	Nyali Tea Exporters Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Oct 7, 1:00 PM	0	$ 5,782.45	$ 1,392.45	24.08	Arrived
MBA/FCL/2026/00004	Sep 12	Sea FCL	Import	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Oct 19, 1:00 PM	-1	$ 2,826.70	$ 631.70	22.35	Customs Cleared
MBA/LCL/2026/00002	Sep 8	Sea LCL	Export	Bahari Retail Group Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Sep 29, 1:00 PM	3	$ 2,006.40	$ 492.60	24.55	Customs Cleared
MBA/FCL/2026/00003	Sep 3	Sea FCL	Import	Coastal Cold Chain Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KENIC - Embakasi Inland Container Depot	Oct 14, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,570.75	$ 375.75	14.62	Delivered
MBA/AIR/2026/00002	Aug 30	Air	Import	Athi Pumps and Irrigation Ltd	CNPVG - Shanghai Pudong	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	Sep 12, 1:00 PM	1	$ 13,161.26	$ 2,264.26	17.20	Delivered
MBA/ROA/2026/00001	Aug 30	Road	Export	Kampala Hardware Traders Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	UGKLA - Kampala Inland Container Depot	Sep 13, 1:00 PM	2	$ 3,250.00	$ 700.00	21.54	Delivered
MBA/LCL/2026/00001	Aug 23	Sea LCL	Import	Sameer Motor Spares Ltd	PKKHI - Karachi	KEMBA - Mombasa	Sep 17, 1:00 PM	0	$ 2,832.55	$ 872.35	30.80	Closed
MBA/AIR/2026/00001	Aug 17	Air	Export	Lake Naivasha Flowers Ltd	KENBO - Jomo Kenyatta International	NLAMS - Amsterdam Schiphol	Aug 29, 1:00 PM	0	$ 8,728.00	$ 1,779.00	20.38	Closed
MBA/FCL/2026/00002	Aug 11	Sea FCL	Export	Nyali Tea Exporters Ltd	KEMBA - Mombasa	AEJEA - Jebel Ali	Sep 1, 1:00 PM	0	$ 5,066.26	$ 676.26	13.35	Closed
MBA/FCL/2026/00001	Aug 5	Sea FCL	Import	Riverside Hardware Ltd	CNSHA - Shanghai	KEMBA - Mombasa	Sep 11, 1:00 PM	4	$ 2,461.55	$ 266.55	10.83	Closed
									$ 68,472.74	$ 12,234.14		

Figure 45. The same thing as a list, file by file, which is what you need in front of you when a customer rings.

> **TIP**
>
> Take the list, not the chart, into a carrier review. An average of four days is an opinion; a list of eight files with their vessel names, voyage numbers and actual arrivals is a claim.

Under target

A file whose margin falls below its lane's target margin, or below the company minimum where the lane has no target, is flagged as under target. Filter the file list on it to see every one of them.

1. Go to **Operations > Job Files**.

2. In the search box choose the **Under Target** filter.
3. Group by **Customer** to see whether it is one account or a general slide.

> CAREFUL
>
> Read the flag against the lane, not against the business. Fourteen percent on the Uganda transit corridor is the target being met; fourteen percent on Far East inbound is four points short. That is the entire reason target margins sit on the lane rather than in one company-wide number.

The agent's share

On a file marked as nominated by an agent, **Agent Share** is what is owed to them out of the profit, worked out from the rate on the agent's record. Only a Freight Manager sees it.

Group the gross profit pivot by **Overseas Agent** before the network statement goes out, so the conversation starts from the same number on both sides.

A monthly routine

- [ ] Clear **Unbilled Files** to nothing, or to files you can explain.
- [ ] Work **Costs Without a Bill** down, chasing the suppliers who have not invoiced.
- [ ] Close every file that is delivered and fully billed on both sides.
- [ ] Read **Gross Profit** by lane and by salesperson against last month.
- [ ] Look at the under target files and ask why, one by one.
- [ ] Take **Arrival Delays** by carrier into the next carrier review.
- [ ] Read **Why We Lose** for the quarter and act on the biggest reason.

CHAPTER 11

Day to day

A page for each job, the questions we are asked most, and the words this system uses for things.

In this chapter

- The operations desk
- The customs broker
- The salesperson
- The manager
- Questions and answers
- Glossary

The operations desk

Every morning

- [ ] Open **Operations > Job Files** and read the files in transit: anything arriving in the next three days.
- [ ] Report yesterday's arrivals on the last leg of each file, and press **Arrived** on the file.
- [ ] Send the arrival notice on anything that has landed.
- [ ] Check the document percentage on every file arriving this week and chase what is missing, by whoever is shown as issuing it.
- [ ] Return the empties that went back yesterday, so detention is counted from the right date.

When a booking comes in

- [ ] Open the file, or win the quotation if there is one.
- [ ] Put the cargo on with tariff codes, case sizes and values.
- [ ] Put the routing on with the vessel or the flight, and the ETD and ETA.
- [ ] Add the containers with their seals and weights.
- [ ] Press **Book**.

Before the cargo moves

- [ ] Issue the master, then the house.
- [ ] Check the house against the master: weight, marks, packages.
- [ ] Mark the boxes stuffed and sealed, then loaded.
- [ ] Press **Sailed**.

The customs broker

- [ ] Raise the entry as soon as the documents are in, not when the vessel berths.
- [ ] Check the tariff codes on the cargo before building the lines: the rate is only as good as the code.
- [ ] Check what has been brought into the value, and reapportion if the freight changed.
- [ ] Chase the permit on anything restricted before the entry is lodged.
- [ ] Lodge it, and record a query the day it comes back.
- [ ] Clear it, put the entry number on, and disburse the duty onto the file.
- [ ] Never disburse on a transit entry.

The salesperson

- [ ] Quote with every charge on it, including the ones that cost nothing to buy.
- [ ] Set a validity date you are willing to be held to, and a transit time you have checked.
- [ ] Watch the margin as you type, not after.
- [ ] Mark a quotation lost the day you know, with the real reason.
- [ ] Answer the activities on your unbilled files. They are your revenue.

The manager

- [ ] Monday: unbilled files, and costs with no bill.
- [ ] Monthly: gross profit by lane and by salesperson; the under target files one at a time.
- [ ] Monthly: close everything that is delivered and billed on both sides.
- [ ] Quarterly: why we lose, and arrival delays by carrier.
- [ ] Quarterly: are the lane targets still the right numbers?

Questions and answers

The file will not let me change the mode.

Once a file is booked the mode is fixed, because the mode is part of the file number and that number is already on a booking with the carrier. Cancel the file and open a new one in the right mode.

I cannot close a file. It says charges have never been invoiced.

Something on the charges tab has a sell rate and no invoice behind it. Either invoice it or take the line off the file. The same check exists on the cost side for costs with a named supplier.

The chargeable weight is not what the airline is charging.

Check the air divisor in **Configuration > Settings**. Six thousand is the IATA figure, but some carriers rate on five thousand, and on a light shipment that difference is real money.

The system refuses my container number.

The last digit is a check digit calculated from the first ten characters under ISO 6346, and the one you typed does not match. The message says what it should have been. Check the number against the carrier's release rather than changing the last digit to whatever the system suggested.

I cannot mark the file delivered.

A required document is still outstanding, and the refusal lists which. Log it in if you have it. If it genuinely is not needed on this kind of file, take it off the required list in **Configuration > Document Types** rather than switching the whole check off.

The duty on this file has wrecked the margin.

It has not; it only looks that way if the duty went on as an ordinary charge. Duty and import VAT must come onto the file through **Disburse Duty to the File** on the entry, which flags them so they never touch the gross profit.

A quotation will not let me mark it won.

Its validity date has passed. Requote it. A rate from six weeks ago is not a rate, and winning against it only moves the loss onto the file.

The entry will not clear.

Either there is no entry number on it, or it carries a restricted tariff line and there is nothing in the licence field. The message names the codes that need a permit.

My branch cannot raise a declaration.

It is set to **Forwarding Only**. Either change the office type, if it really does hold a licence, or file through the office that does.

A salesperson says files are missing from their list.

They are not missing. Freight Sales sees only quotations where they are the salesperson and files where they are the salesperson or opened the file. If they need to see the branch's whole book, they need a different role.

Can I edit an invoiced charge?

Not the money. Once the invoice is posted the rate, quantity, tax, currency, billing party and charge code are locked; the description can still be corrected. If the invoice is wrong, credit it.

The ETA on the file is not what I typed.

The file takes its ETD from the first routing leg and its ETA from the last one. If the ETA looks early, the file is probably missing its on-carriage leg: the ship's leg ends at the port, not at the inland depot.

Glossary

Chargeable weight

The greater of the actual weight and the volume converted to kilos. Every per kilo rate on a file is applied to it.

Consignee

Who the cargo is consigned to on the bill. Not necessarily who pays the invoice.

Disbursement

Money laid out for the customer, usually duty and import VAT, recharged at cost and never counted as revenue.

FCL

Full container load. The box is the unit.

House bill

The bill between you and your customer. Several can sit under one master.

Incoterm

Where your responsibility ends and theirs begins. It decides who pays which leg.

LCL

Less than a container load, also called groupage. Rated on weight or measure.

Master bill

The bill between you and the carrier. One per file.

Nomination

Business an overseas agent found and sent to you, with the profit shared at the rate on their record.

Notify party

Who the carrier calls when the vessel berths.

NVOCC

A carrier that issues its own bills without owning ships.

Regime

What the goods are being entered for: home use, export, transit, warehousing and so on.

TEU

Twenty foot equivalent unit. A forty foot box is two.

Trade lane

A pair of countries, with a target margin.

Transit

Goods crossing a country on their way somewhere else, secured by a bond rather than by payment.

VGM

Verified gross mass. The tare plus the cargo, declared before the box is loaded.

Volumetric weight

Volume turned into kilos by the divisor for the mode.

SUPPORT

Way4Tech, info@way4tech.com, www.way4tech.com. Quote the file number and what you pressed; the message the system gave you is usually the whole answer, and it is always worth sending with the question.